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MAJOR PROJECT REPORT ON

" DEVELOPMENT OF TRAFFIC CLEARANCE SYSTEM FOR EMERGENCY VEHICLE "

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING IN

ELECTRONICS AND COMMUNICATION ENGINEERING

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2025 - 26

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled "**DEVELOPMENT OF TRAFFIC CLEARANCE SYSTEM FOR EMERGENCY VEHICLES**"carriedout by **Pavan Shetty H S**(4AI22EC078),**Pratham J S** (4AI22EC083), **Sachin N** (4AI22EC092),**Thejomurthi A** (4AI22EC114) a Bonafide students of Adichunchanagiri Institute of Technology in partial fulfilment for the award of Bachelor of Engineering in Electronics and Communication Engineering of the Visveswaraya Technological University, Belgaum during the year 2024-2025. It is certified that all corrections/suggestions indicated for Internal Assessment have been incorporated in the Report deposited in the departmental library. The project report has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements in respect of Project work prescribed for the said Degree.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We express our sincere and humble pranama's to his holiness **D Kalabhiraviakya Padmabhushana SRI SRI SRI Dr. Balagangadharanatha Maha Swamiji** and seek their blessings.

We express our sincere and humble pranama's to his holiness **SRI SRI SRI Dr.Nirmalanandanatha Maha Swamiji**, **SRI SRI SRI Gunanathaswamiji** and seek their blessings.

We are deeply indebted to honorable Director **Dr. C K Subbaraya** for creating the right kind of care and ambience.

We are thankful to our beloved Principal **Dr. C T Jayadeva** for inspiring us to achieve greater endeavors in all aspects of learning.

We express deepest gratitude to **Dr. Goutham M.A**, Professor & Head, Department of Electronics & Communication Engineering for his valuable guidance, suggestions and constant encouragement.

We are grateful to our Guide **Mrs.Linet D Souza** and our reviewer **Dr.Raghu Kumar B S** for their excellent guidance, support,constructive suggestions and encouragement that led us through the presentation.

We are also thankful to our project coordinator **Dr. Anil Kumar C** for his inspiration and lively correspondence for carrying our work.

DECLARATION

We declare that this project report titled “Development of Traffic Clearance System for Emergency Vehicle” submitted in partial fulfillment of the degree of B. Tech in Electronics and Communication Engineering is a record of original work carried out by me under the supervision of Mrs. LINET D SOUZA B.E., M.Tech.Assistant professor ,and has not formed the basis for the award of any other degree, in this or any other Institution or University. In keeping with theethical practice in reporting scientific information, due acknowledgements have been made wherever the findings of others have been cited.

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Abstract

The increasing frequency of traffic congestion in urban areas poses significant challenges to the timely response of emergency vehicles, such as ambulances, fire trucks, and police vehicles. Traditional traffic signal systems, often pre-timed or manually controlled, fail to adapt to real-time traffic conditions, leading to delays that can compromise public safety. This paper presents the development of an advanced traffic signal clearance system utilizing control systems to prioritize emergency vehicles, thereby enhancing their response times and overall efficiency.The proposed system integrates adaptive traffic signal control with emergency vehicle detection mechanisms. Using technologies such as GPS, RFID, and IoT sensors, the system identifies the presence of emergency vehicles approaching intersections. Upon detection, the system dynamically adjusts traffic signals to create a clear path, granting immediate green lights to the emergency vehicles while maintaining optimal traffic flow for other vehicles.A key feature of this system is its ability to communicate with centralized traffic management centers, allowing for real-time monitoring and coordination across multiple intersections. This centralized approach enables the creation of 'green corridors'—continuous paths of green signals—that facilitate uninterrupted movement for emergency vehicles over extended urban areas. The implementation of this system has been shown to significantly reduce the response times of emergency vehicles, thereby improving the effectiveness of emergency services. Furthermore, by minimizing delays and optimizing traffic flow, the system contributes to overall traffic management efficiency and public safety.In conclusion, the development and deployment of control systems for traffic signal clearance represent a critical advancement in urban traffic management. By prioritizing emergency vehicles, these systems not only enhance emergency response times but also promote safer and more efficient urban environments.

CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

Today, the world's development is moving at a breakneck pace. Keeping up with the ever- increasing number of people and vehicles on the road is becoming increasingly difficult and dangerous as a result of technological advancements, and the healthcare industry faces its own unique set of challenges in this regard. As a result, major cities are plagued by traffic gridlock. Many countries' transportation systems are adversely affected by traffic congestion. Tragedy in the roads has a significant impact on ambulance service. Ambulances frequently transport critically ill or injured patients who must be transported to a hospital as quickly as possible so that they can receive the treatment they need to survive. Patients can die if the ambulance takes too long to arrive at the hospital. Most heart attacks can be treated if the ambulance arrives at the hospital in time, according to studies. 95 percent of the time. This necessitates the traffic on the road moving over to allow room for the ambulance. However, there are times when the ambulance gets stuck in traffic, which results in a lot of wasted time.

In developing nations, where traffic discipline is often compromised and infrastructure limitations persist, the need for intelligent traffic management becomes even more critical. Emergency vehicles frequently struggle to navigate through congested intersections, with studies showing that ambulance response times in urban areas exceed recommended thresholds by 30-40%. The manual intervention currently required – such as traffic police clearing paths for ambulances – is inefficient and inconsistent.

The main goal of this system is to enable the ambulance to reach a specific location without having to stop anywhere until it reaches the destination. Ambulance drivers will be able to monitor and control traffic lights in this paper. The status of the patient, such as critical or noncritical, is also taken into consideration. This data is then used to send it to a hospital for further treatment. The driver sends the vehicle in the desired direction based on the severity of the situation. Depending on the command, that particular signal is made green to make way for the ambulance, and the other signals are changed to red at the same time. As a result of using this method, the ambulance is able to get to its destination.

The system operates in two distinct modes normal operation with timer-based signal control optimized for traffic flow, and emergency mode that provides immediate priority to detected ambulances. The integration of OLED displays at each lane provides clear countdown timers and emergency notifications to drivers, while the web dashboard enables traffic authorities to monitor system performance, analyze patterns, and intervene when necessary.This implementation focuses on a four-way intersection as a proof of concept, demonstrating scalability potential for city-wide deployment. The system's modular architecture allows for easy integration with existing traffic infrastructure while providing a cost-effective upgrade path for municipalities. By reducing emergency response times and improving overall traffic flow efficiency, this system directly contributes to public safety and quality of life improvements in urban environments. Edge computing also reduces the load on communication networks and enhances system reliability, as decisions do not depend on potentially delayed or disrupted connections to remote servers. Overall, it enables faster, more efficient, and resilient operations in intelligent transportation systems, ensuring that time-sensitive actions can occur within milliseconds, which is crucial for safety and traffic optimization.

1.1 OVERVIEW :

This project develops a comprehensive solution that addresses these challenges through an integrated approach combining:

1.1.1 Automated traffic signal control with programmable cycles : Automated traffic signal control with programmable cycles is a traffic management approach in which signal timings are pre-configured yet flexible, allowing intersections to adapt to varying traffic conditions throughout the day. Instead of relying on a fixed, unchanging timer, these systems use programmable controllers that let engineers define how long each signal phase—green, yellow, and red—should last during specific time periods, such as morning rush hour, midday, or late at night. The cycles can be adjusted to prioritize busy routes, coordinate multiple intersections, or reduce delays in low-traffic conditions. More advanced versions can integrate sensor data or historical traffic patterns to refine these timings automatically. By enabling precise, predictable, and adaptable control, programmable traffic cycles improve overall traffic flow, reduce congestion and emissions, enhance safety, and create a more efficient transportation environment.

1.1.2 Real-time computer vision for emergency vehicle detection : Real-time computer vision for emergency vehicle detection uses cameras and advanced AI algorithms to continuously analyze live video streams and identify approaching ambulances, fire trucks, or police vehicles within milliseconds. The system recognizes key visual features—such as vehicle shape, color patterns, flashing lights, and motion characteristics—and distinguishes emergency vehicles from regular traffic with high accuracy. Once detected, the information is instantly relayed to the traffic signal controller, which can automatically adjust lights to create a clear path, reducing delays and minimizing the risk of collisions at intersections. This technology significantly improves emergency response times by ensuring that first responders move through traffic more efficiently. It also reduces reliance on manual intervention, enhances overall traffic safety, and enables smarter, more responsive transportation infrastructure capable of supporting real-time decision-making.

1.1.3 Edge computing for rapid response times : Edge computing for rapid response times is a technology approach in which data is processed locally, near the source of generation—such as traffic cameras, sensors, or roadside controllers—rather than being sent to centralized cloud servers for analysis. By handling data at the “edge” of the network, the system can make decisions almost instantly, minimizing latency and enabling immediate responses to critical events. In traffic management, this allows signals to change in real time based on current conditions, such as adjusting light cycles for congestion, detecting accidents, or giving priority to emergency vehicles. Edge computing also reduces the load on communication networks and enhances system reliability, as decisions do not depend on potentially delayed or disrupted connections to remote servers. Overall, it enables faster, more efficient, and resilient operations in intelligent transportation systems, ensuring that time-sensitive actions can occur within milliseconds, which is crucial for safety and traffic optimization. The system's modular architecture allows for easy integration with existing traffic infrastructure while providing a cost-effective upgrade path for municipalities. By reducing emergency response times and improving overall traffic flow efficiency, this system directly contributes to public safety and quality of life improvements in urban environments.

1.1.4 Cloud connectivity for remote monitoring and data analytics : Cloud connectivity for remote monitoring and data analytics enables traffic management systems to transmit data from local devices—such as sensors, cameras, and signal controllers—to cloud-based platforms where it can be stored, processed, and analyzed. This connectivity allows transportation authorities to monitor system performance, detect faults, and observe traffic patterns in real time from any location, without the need for on-site intervention. The cloud's computational power supports advanced analytics, including congestion prediction, optimization of traffic signal timings, long-term trend analysis, and automated reporting. Additionally, cloud platforms can integrate data from multiple sources, enabling a holistic view of city-wide traffic conditions and supporting data-driven decision-making. By combining remote access with robust analytical capabilities, cloud connectivity enhances system reliability, operational efficiency, and strategic planning, ultimately improving traffic flow, safety, and the overall effectiveness of intelligent transportation systems.

1.1.5 Multi-modal feedback systems including visual displays and acoustic alerts : Multi-modal feedback systems that incorporate visual displays and acoustic alerts provide information through more than one sensory channel, making communication clearer and more effective. Visual displays—such as LED panels, traffic signal indicators, or dashboard notifications—offer precise, easily interpretable cues that users can quickly understand at a glance. Acoustic alerts—like beeps, tones, alarms, or spoken messages—ensure that important warnings are noticed even when the user is distracted, not facing the display, or in low-visibility conditions. By combining both visual and auditory elements, these systems significantly improve safety, accessibility, and response times, helping drivers, pedestrians, and cyclists react promptly to changes in their surroundings. This layered approach reduces the chance of missed signals and enhances reliability in environments where rapid decision-making is essential, such as transportation systems, public safety applications, and industrial settings.

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1.2 LITERATURE SURVEY :

A comprehensive review of existing literature, research papers, and implemented systems reveals various approaches to intelligent traffic management and emergency vehicle detection. This survey examines the evolution of traffic control systems, current technologies, and identifies gaps that this project aims to address.

[1] "Shantanu P Rajurkar","Traffic Management and Signal Manipulation system using Machine Learning",2024

This study explores a novel method to traffic control that enhances signal control systems in metropolitan environments by applying machine learning techniques. This research revolves around a methodology that improves vehicle flow and reduces traffic congestion. This paper elaborates on the methodology utilized for collection of data and vehicle detection methods used for optimizing traffic signals. The findings reveal noteworthy enhancements in improving vehicle detection such a as map50 of 80.5% of various types of vehicles pertaining to Indian traffic using Yolo V8. In essence, this research endeavors to transcend traditional paradigms of traffic management, ushering in a new era of intelligent infrastructure capable of harmonizing vehicular movement.

[2]"M.Satyakumar","Emergency Vehicle SignalPre-emptionSystem for Heterogeneous Traffic Condition : A Case Study in Trivandrum City",2019

Emergency vehicles play a critical role in effective delivery of emergency services. Traffic congestion and delay at intersection are the major reasons that increase the response time of emergency vehicles. This study focusses on the need for emergency vehicle signal pre-emption of major intersections for Indian environment, with the limelight on Trivandrum city as the study area. The data comprising of traffic volume, spot speed, existing signal timings and geometric variables were collected for three signalized intersections. The proposed method considers the three approaching scenarios, so that traffic queues at the intersections on a given emergency route can be cleared in advance for an emergency vehicle, while minimizing delay because of unnecessary pre-emption. Emergency vehicle signal pre-emption system design was done which includes the determination of EV detection distance. The proposed design was simulated in a traffic network using a microscopic simulation model using VISSIM Software, which was calibrated with the traffic data collected from the network. The performance of the proposed pre-emption was compared with existing system. The findings show that the proposed method can reduce up to 25 - 30% of emergency vehicle delay at signalised intersection.

[3] "Deepa Gupta","Computer Vision Based Traffic Monitoring System",2024

This research paper explores the integration of cutting-edge computer vision technologies in the domain of traffic monitoring to revolutionize traditional methods of traffic management. As urbanization and vehicular density continue to rise, the demand for efficient and intelligent traffic management systems becomes increasingly imperative. The study investigates the deployment of new technologies that have not been fully harnessed, coupled with enhancements to conventional methods, to create a comprehensive and adaptable traffic monitoring system. The paper delves into the potential of computer vision techniques for the enhancement of smart city applications. Furthermore, the research explores how these advancements can be seamlessly integrated with existing infrastructure to augment and refine

conventional traffic management strategies. In addition to introducing novel technologies, the research emphasizes the importance of optimizing the utilization of existing resources. By upgrading conventional methods through the incorporation of computer vision, the paper outlines a holistic approach to traffic management that maximizes efficiency, reduces congestion, and enhances overall transportation system performance. Through a severe combination of theoretical frameworks and case studies this research contributes to the ongoing discourse on intelligent transportation systems. The findings not only highlight the potential of computer vision in the realm of traffic monitoring but also offer actionable insights for policymakers, urban planners, and transportation authorities seeking to enhance the effectiveness of traffic management in the face of evolving urban landscapes.

1.3 RELATED TECHNOLOGIES :

1.3.1 Edge Computing and IoT :

The convergence of IoT and edge computing has transformed intelligent infrastructure development. Shi et al. (2016) coined the term "edge computing" for processing data at the network edge rather than distant data centers. For traffic management applications, this approach offers critical advantages:

Reduced Latency: Processing traffic camera data locally eliminates round-trip time to cloud servers. Research by Hassan et al. (2018) demonstrated latency reduction from 3-5 seconds (cloud) to under 500 milliseconds (edge) for object detection tasks, crucial for time-sensitive traffic control decisions.

Network Resilience: Edge-based systems continue functioning during internet outages. Chen et al. (2019) emphasized this reliability advantage for critical infrastructure applications where continuous operation is non-negotiable.

Bandwidth Efficiency: Transmitting processed detection events requires far less bandwidth than streaming raw video. Kumar and Singh (2020) calculated bandwidth reduction of 95% when processing video locally versus cloud streaming, significantly lowering operational costs for multi-intersection deployments.

1.3.2 Machine Learning on Embedded Systems :

Deploying machine learning models on resource-constrained devices presents unique challenges addressed by several frameworks:

TensorFlow Lite: Google's TensorFlow Lite framework enables deployment of neural networks on microcontrollers and mobile devices. David et al. (2019) demonstrated successful deployment of image classification models on ARM Cortex-M microcontrollers with only 256KB RAM, though with simplified architectures and quantized weights. For Raspberry Pi platforms, TensorFlow Lite achieves much higher performance, supporting complex CNNs in real-time.

Edge Impulse: This platform specializes in machine learning for edge devices, providing end-to-end workflows from data collection to model deployment. Janapa Reddi et al. (2020) highlighted Edge Impulse's optimization capabilities, achieving 3-5x speedup compared to standard TensorFlow models through automated hardware-specific optimizations.

Model Optimization Techniques: Several techniques enable efficient embedded ML deployment. Quantization reduces model size and computational requirements by using 8-bit integers instead of 32-bit floats. Pruning removes unnecessary neural network connections. Knowledge distillation trains smaller "student" models to mimic larger "teacher" models. Research by Han et al. (2016) achieved 35-49x compression ratios while maintaining accuracy within 1% of original models.

1.3.3 Real-Time Communication Protocols :

Effective communication between traffic control hardware and monitoring dashboards requires appropriate protocols:

MQTT (Message Queuing Telemetry Transport): A lightweight publish-subscribe protocol ideal for IoT applications. Stanford-Clark and Truong (2013) designed MQTT for unreliable networks with minimal overhead. Traffic management systems benefit from MQTT's low bandwidth requirements and support for unreliable network conditions. Multiple studies demonstrate MQTT's suitability for real-time monitoring applications.

WebSocket: Enables full-duplex communication between web clients and servers. Pimentel and Nickerson (2012) compared WebSocket to traditional HTTP polling and found 60-70% reduction in bandwidth usage and significantly lower latency for real-time updates. WebSocket is particularly suitable for web dashboard interfaces requiring live data feeds.

HTTP/REST APIs: While less efficient than MQTT or WebSocket for continuous streaming, RESTful APIs remain valuable for occasional data queries, configuration updates, and manual control commands. Their ubiquity and simplicity make them ideal for dashboard control functions.

1.3.4 Cloud Platforms for IoT :

Modern IoT platforms simplify cloud integration for embedded systems:

Firebase Realtime Database: Provides real-time data synchronization with automatic client updates. Research by Google (2019) highlighted Firebase's ability to handle millions of concurrent connections with sub-second latency, making it suitable for large-scale traffic monitoring deployments.

AWS IoT Core: Amazon's IoT platform offers device authentication, message routing, and integration with AWS services. Analyses by Naik (2017) demonstrated AWS IoT's scalability and security features, though at higher cost and complexity compared to Firebase.

ThingSpeak and Similar Platforms: Purpose-built for sensor data aggregation and visualization. These platforms offer simple APIs and built-in analytics but may lack the flexibility required for complex traffic management applications.

1.4 MOTIVATION :

The motivation for this project stems from several critical factors:

1.4.1 Life-Saving Potential:

Emergency medical services operate under extreme time constraints. The "golden hour" concept in trauma care emphasizes that survival rates drop dramatically when treatment is delayed. In cardiac emergencies, brain damage begins within 4-6 minutes of cardiac arrest. Every second saved in transit can mean the difference between life and death, full recovery and permanent disability. Current traffic systems do not adequately support these time-critical operations, leaving emergency responders to navigate congested intersections manually, often with limited visibility and cooperation from other drivers.

1.4.2 Technological Feasibility:

Modern computer vision and machine learning technologies have matured to the point where reliable vehicle classification is achievable even on low-cost embedded platforms. Pre-trained models can be fine-tuned for ambulance detection with relatively modest datasets. Edge computing capabilities eliminate latency issues associated with cloud-based processing, enabling real-time response. The decreasing cost of cameras, microcontrollers, and sensors makes implementation economically viable even for municipalities with limited budgets.

1.4.3 Urban Infrastructure Demands:

As cities grow denser and traffic volumes increase, traditional traffic management approaches become inadequate. Smart city initiatives worldwide are seeking technology-driven solutions to improve urban efficiency, safety, and livability. Intelligent traffic systems represent a key component of this transformation, offering benefits beyond emergency response including reduced congestion.

1.4.4 Data-Driven Optimization:

Modern traffic systems generate vast amounts of data that remain underutilized. By integrating monitoring dashboards and logging capabilities, traffic management can transition from reactive to proactive, using historical data to identify patterns, optimize signal timing, and plan infrastructure improvements. Emergency response data can help identify high-traffic corridors requiring alternative routing or additional infrastructure.

1.4.5 Scalability and Integration:

The modular design of IoT-based systems allows for incremental deployment and easy integration with existing infrastructure. A system proven effective at a single intersection can be replicated across an entire traffic network, with centralized monitoring enabling coordinated responses across multiple junctions. This scalability makes the solution attractive for both pilot programs and city-wide deployments.

1.5 OBJECTIVES :

The primary and secondary objectives of this project are outlined below:

1.5.1 Primary Objectives:

1. Automated Traffic Signal Control:Design and implement a robust timer-based traffic signal control system for a 4-way junction that manages traffic flow efficiently under normal operating conditions. The system should support programmable signal timing cycles with smooth transitions between green, yellow, and red phases for each lane.

2. Real-Time Ambulance Detection:Develop and deploy a machine learning-based computer vision system capable of detecting ambulances in real-time from camera feeds with high accuracy (target >95%). The detection system must function reliably under various lighting conditions, weather scenarios, and traffic densities.

3. Emergency Signal OverrideSystem:Implement an intelligent override mechanism that automatically grants signal priority to detected ambulances by switching the ambulance lane to green and all other lanes to red, ensuring clear passage through the junction. The override should activate within 2-3 seconds of detection.

4. User Interface and Feedback Systems:Integrate OLED displays at each lane to provide real-time information including current signal status, countdown timers, and emergency alerts. Implement acoustic feedback through sound sensors to enhance driver awareness during emergency conditions.

5. Web-Based Monitoring Dashboard:Develop a comprehensive cloud-connected web dashboard that provides traffic control authorities with real-time monitoring capabilities, including live camera feeds, signal status visualization, emergency event logging with timestamps, and manual override controls for maintenance and testing purposes.

1.5.2 Secondary Objectives:

6. Data Logging and Analytics:Implement comprehensive event logging to record all system activities, including normal signal cycles, emergency detections, override activations, and system health metrics. This data will support post-deployment analysis, optimization, and reporting.

7. System Reliability and Fail-Safe Mechanisms:Ensure system reliability through robust error handling, fail-safe mechanisms that default to standard traffic patterns in case of component failure, and recovery protocols that minimize system downtime and maintain safe operation under all conditions.

8. Scalability and Modularity:Design the system architecture with modularity and scalability in mind, enabling easy replication across multiple junctions, integration with existing traffic networks, and future expansion to support additional features such as detection of other emergency vehicles or integration with city-wide traffic management systems.

9.Cost-Effective Implementation:Develop a solution that balances performance with cost-effectiveness, utilizing affordable components and open-source software where possible to make the system accessible for deployment in municipalities with varying budget constraints.

10.Environmental and Traffic Flow Optimization:Beyond emergency response, optimize the traffic signal timing algorithms to reduce vehicle idle time at intersections, thereby decreasing fuel consumption and emissions while improving overall traffic flow efficiency.

Summary :

This chapter introduces the need for an intelligent traffic management system capable of reducing congestion and improving emergency vehicle movement, especially in rapidly growing urban environments. Traditional traffic systems often fail to provide timely clearance for ambulances, leading to delayed medical response and increased risk to patient lives. To address these challenges, the project proposes an integrated solution using automated traffic signal control, real-time computer vision for ambulance detection, edge computing for low-latency decisions, cloud connectivity for monitoring, and multimodal feedback systems.A review of existing literature highlights advances in machine learning, emergency vehicle pre-emption strategies, and computer vision–based traffic monitoring. Related technologies—including IoT, edge computing, embedded machine learning, communication protocols, and cloud platforms—form the technological foundation of the proposed system.The chapter also outlines the motivation behind the project, emphasizing life-saving potential, technological feasibility, urban infrastructure demands, data-driven optimization, and system scalability. Finally, it states the primary goals such as automated signal control, real-time ambulance detection, emergency overrides, user interfaces, and dashboards, along with secondary objectives like data logging, reliability, modularity, cost-effectiveness, and environmental benefits.

CHAPTER 2

SYSTEM DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

2.1 BLOCK DIAGRAM :

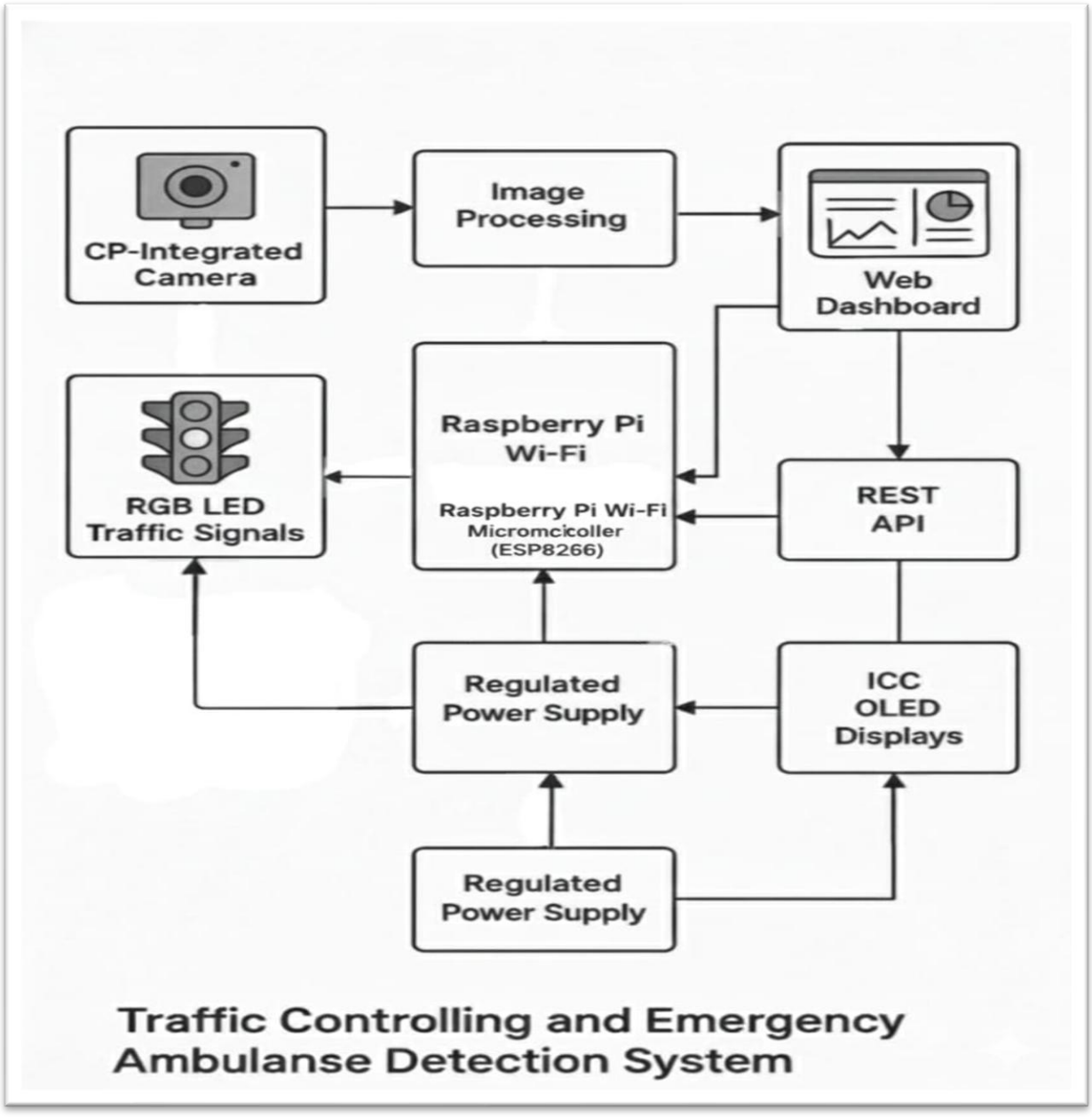

Fig 2.1 : Block diagram of traffic control system for ambulance

The Traffic Controlling and Emergency Ambulance Detection System depicted in the diagram is a sophisticated integration of computer vision, microcontroller-based control, wireless communication, and cloud connectivity designed to enhance traffic management and prioritize emergency vehicles in real time. The process begins with a CP-integrated camera that continuously captures live video footage of an intersection, feeding this visual data into an image processing unit where advanced computer vision algorithms analyze each frame to detect the presence of emergency vehicles such as ambulances. These algorithms focus on identifying unique features like flashing lights, specific vehicle shapes, or patterns consistent with emergency sirens, allowing the system to reliably distinguish emergency vehicles from normal traffic. Once an ambulance or other emergency vehicle is detected, the information is immediately relayed to a web dashboard that serves as a centralized monitoring interface, providing traffic authorities with real-time updates, detailed analytics, and alert notifications.

The web dashboard communicates with the hardware control components through a REST API, which acts as an intermediary layer facilitating seamless, two-way data exchange between the cloud-based platform and the physical traffic infrastructure. Central to the control mechanism is a Raspberry Pi equipped with Wi-Fi capabilities and an ESP8266 microcontroller, which receives commands via the REST API and executes control logic for the traffic signals. This microcontroller acts as the brain of the system, dynamically adjusting the RGB LED traffic lights based on the detection data to prioritize the ambulance's route by turning the appropriate signals green, while managing other lanes to ensure safety and smooth traffic flow.

Additionally, the system includes ICC OLED displays positioned at the intersection, which provide immediate local visual feedback, such as emergency alerts or traffic status, enhancing situational awareness for drivers and pedestrians. The entire setup is powered by regulated power supplies that guarantee stable and reliable operation of the Raspberry Pi, traffic signals, and display units, minimizing the risk of power fluctuations causing system failure. By combining these elements, the system not only automates the detection and prioritization of emergency vehicles to reduce their response time but also supports comprehensive traffic monitoring through a remote-accessible web interface, enabling data-driven decisions and proactive traffic management. This holistic approach significantly improves intersection safety, optimizes traffic flow by reducing unnecessary waiting times, and ultimately contributes to more efficient urban mobility and faster emergency response, demonstrating how modern IoT and AI technologies can be effectively leveraged to solve real-world transportation challenges. These algorithms focus on identifying unique features like flashing lights, specific vehicle shapes, or patterns consistent with emergency sirens, allowing the system to reliably distinguish emergency vehicles from normal traffic. Once an ambulance or other emergency vehicle is detected, the information is immediately relayed to a web dashboard that serves as a centralized monitoring interface, providing traffic authorities with real-time updates, detailed analytics, and alert notifications. . This microcontroller acts as the brain of the system, dynamically adjusting the RGB LED traffic lights based on the detection data to prioritize the ambulance's route by turning the appropriate signals green, while managing other lanes to ensure safety and smooth traffic flow.

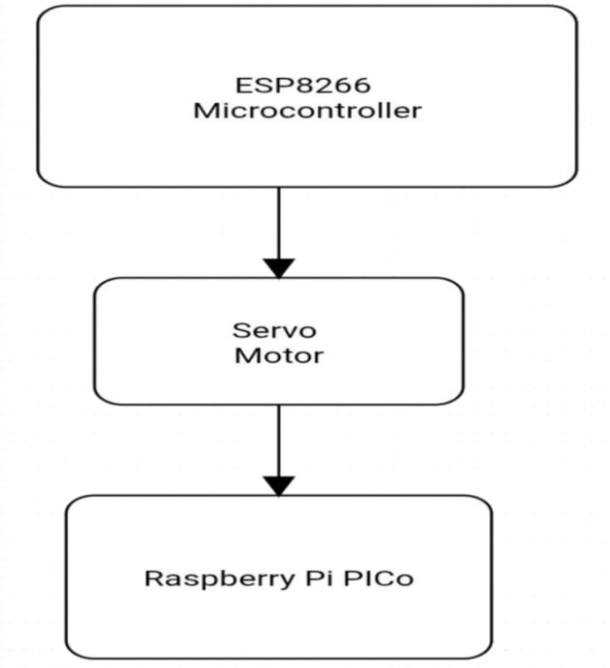

Fig 2.2 : Block diagram servo motor operation

The flow diagram illustrates a simple but effective control system involving three key components: the ESP8266 microcontroller, a servo motor, and a Raspberry Pi Pico, showing a sequential data and control flow between them. At the top of the chain is the ESP8266 microcontroller, a popular, low-cost Wi-Fi-enabled device commonly used in Internet of Things (IoT) projects for its ability to communicate wirelessly and handle sensor inputs or commands. This microcontroller serves as the initial decision-making or command unit, where it generates control signals or processes inputs, which it then sends directly to the servo motor. The servo motor acts as an actuator in the system, receiving precise control signals from the ESP8266, enabling it to rotate or position itself at specific angles.

The role of the servo motor here is to physically execute or translate the control instructions it receives, converting electronic signals into mechanical motion with high accuracy. Finally, the output or feedback from the servo motor is passed on to the Raspberry Pi Pico, a compact and versatile microcontroller board known for its powerful processing capabilities and extensive I/O options. The Raspberry Pi Pico likely performs additional processing, monitoring, or coordination tasks based on the servo motor's status or position, effectively acting as a secondary controller or data collection point in the system. Together, this configuration shows a streamlined and efficient workflow where the ESP8266 microcontroller initiates control commands, the servo motor executes physical movements, and the Raspberry Pi Pico processes or responds to these actions, making the system suitable for applications requiring precise control and communication between wireless microcontrollers and mechanical actuators in embedded systems, robotics, or automated control environments.

2.2 METHODOLOGY :

Methodology for Development of Traffic Clearance System for Ambulance Using Image Processing with Web Dashboard Monitoring

2.2.1 Data Acquisition : The system begins by installing cameras at strategic traffic intersections to continuously capture live video footage of the road and vehicles. These cameras act as the primary data source for monitoring traffic and detecting emergency vehicles such as ambulances.

2.2.2 Image Processing and Ambulance Detection: The captured video streams are processed in real time using image processing techniques combined with machine learning algorithms. Key features like ambulance shapes, colors, flashing lights, and sirens are detected through methods such as object detection, pattern recognition, and color filtering to accurately identify ambulances amidst regular traffic.

2.2.3 Signal Processing and Control Logic : Once an ambulance is detected, the system activates predefined control logic to prioritize the ambulance's movement. This involves dynamically adjusting the traffic signal timings—extending green lights or turning red lights for other directions—to create a clear path for the emergency vehicle, thus minimizing delays.

2.2.4 Hardware Integration : The control signals are sent to microcontroller units (e.g., Raspberry Pi, ESP8266) that interface directly with RGB LED traffic lights to implement the real-time changes in traffic signals. Additional components like servo motors may be used if mechanical adjustments or additional signaling mechanisms are involved.

2.2.5 Web Dashboard Development :A web-based dashboard is developed to provide remote monitoring and control capabilities. This dashboard displays live traffic data, ambulance detection status, and traffic signal conditions, enabling traffic management authorities to oversee the system and intervene if necessary.

2.2.6Communication Protocol: Communication between the image processing unit microcontrollers, and the web dashboard is established through REST APIs over Wi-Fi or other network protocols. This ensures real-time data exchange, allowing instantaneous updates on traffic conditions and signal status.

2.2.7 Power Management : The entire system is supported by regulated power supplies to ensure stable operation of cameras, microcontrollers, traffic signals, and displays, minimizing downtime or interruptions.

2.2.8 Testing and Calibration : The system undergoes thorough testing in real-world traffic scenarios to calibrate detection algorithms, signal timing adjustments, and communication reliability. Feedback from testing is used to refine the system for accuracy, responsiveness, and robustness.

2.2.9 Deployment and Maintenance: After successful testing, the system is deployed at multiple intersections. Regular maintenance and software updates are planned to accommodate changes in traffic patterns, improve detection algorithms, and incorporate new features for enhanced traffic management and emergency response efficiency.This structured methodology ensures a comprehensive approach to developing a traffic clearance system that effectively detects ambulances, controls traffic signals dynamically, and provides continuous remote monitoring through a web dashboard, ultimately improving emergency vehicle response times and traffic safety.

2.3 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE :

2.3.1 System Design Approach :

The development follows an iterative, modular approach divided into six distinct phases, each building upon the previous to create a comprehensive solution.

2.3.2 Requirements Analysis and Planning :

- Conducted field studies at busy intersections to understand traffic patterns
- Analyzed emergency response data to identify critical delay points
- Defined system specifications based on stakeholder requirements
- Created detailed project timeline with milestones and deliverables

2.3.3 System Architecture Design :

The system employs a three-tier architecture:

- **Edge Layer:** Raspberry Pi units at intersections handling real-time processing
- **Communication Layer:** MQTT/HTTP protocols for data transmission
- **Cloud Layer:** Web dashboard and data storage for monitoring and analytics

2.3.4 Hardware Implementation Methodology

Each component was selected based on specific criteria:

- **Raspberry Pi 4B**: Chosen for its processing power (1.5GHz quad-core), RAM (4GB), and native camera interface
- **Camera Module**: Selected high-resolution (8MP) camera with wide-angle lens for comprehensive lane coverage

- **OLED Displays**: I2C protocol chosen for simplified wiring and reliable communication
- **LED Arrays**: High-brightness LEDs with proper current limiting for daylight visibility

2.3.5 Circuit Design and Integration

1. **Power Distribution Design**

- Calculated total power requirements: 15W peak consumption
- Designed regulated 5V/3A supply with backup battery support
- Implemented protection circuits for voltage spikes and reverse polarity.

2. Signal Interfacing :

- GPIO pin allocation optimized for minimal interference
- Pull-up/pull-down resistors configured for stable signal reading
- Optocouplers used for high-voltage LED array isolation

3. Communication Bus Architecture :

- I2C bus for OLED displays with address configuration
- SPI for high-speed camera data transfer
- UART for debug output and system monitoring

2.4 CIRCUIT DIAGRAM :

The circuit diagram represents an integrated traffic signal control system utilizing a Raspberry Pi Pico W microcontroller as the central processing unit to coordinate multiple hardware components for effective traffic management and monitoring. The system controls four distinct traffic signal units, each comprising the standard red, yellow, and green LEDs, which are directly connected to various General Purpose Input/Output (GPIO) pins on the Raspberry Pi Pico W. This setup allows the microcontroller to individually manage the timing and state of each traffic light, enabling dynamic and responsive traffic control. Additionally, a PLCamera module is connected to the system, serving as the image acquisition device that continuously captures real-time traffic footage for processing and analysis. This camera feeds data that can be used to identify emergency vehicles like ambulances or to monitor traffic congestion. The control signals required to actuate higher power loads or to isolate the microcontroller from the direct current demands of the traffic signals are handled by a relay module, which is interfaced with the Raspberry Pi Pico W through dedicated GPIO pins. The relay module functions as an electrically operated switch, allowing the microcontroller to turn the traffic lights on or off safely and efficiently. Powering this entire setup is a 5V/12V regulated power supply that ensures stable and consistent voltage levels, critical for the reliable operation of the microcontroller, relays, camera module, and the OLED displays.

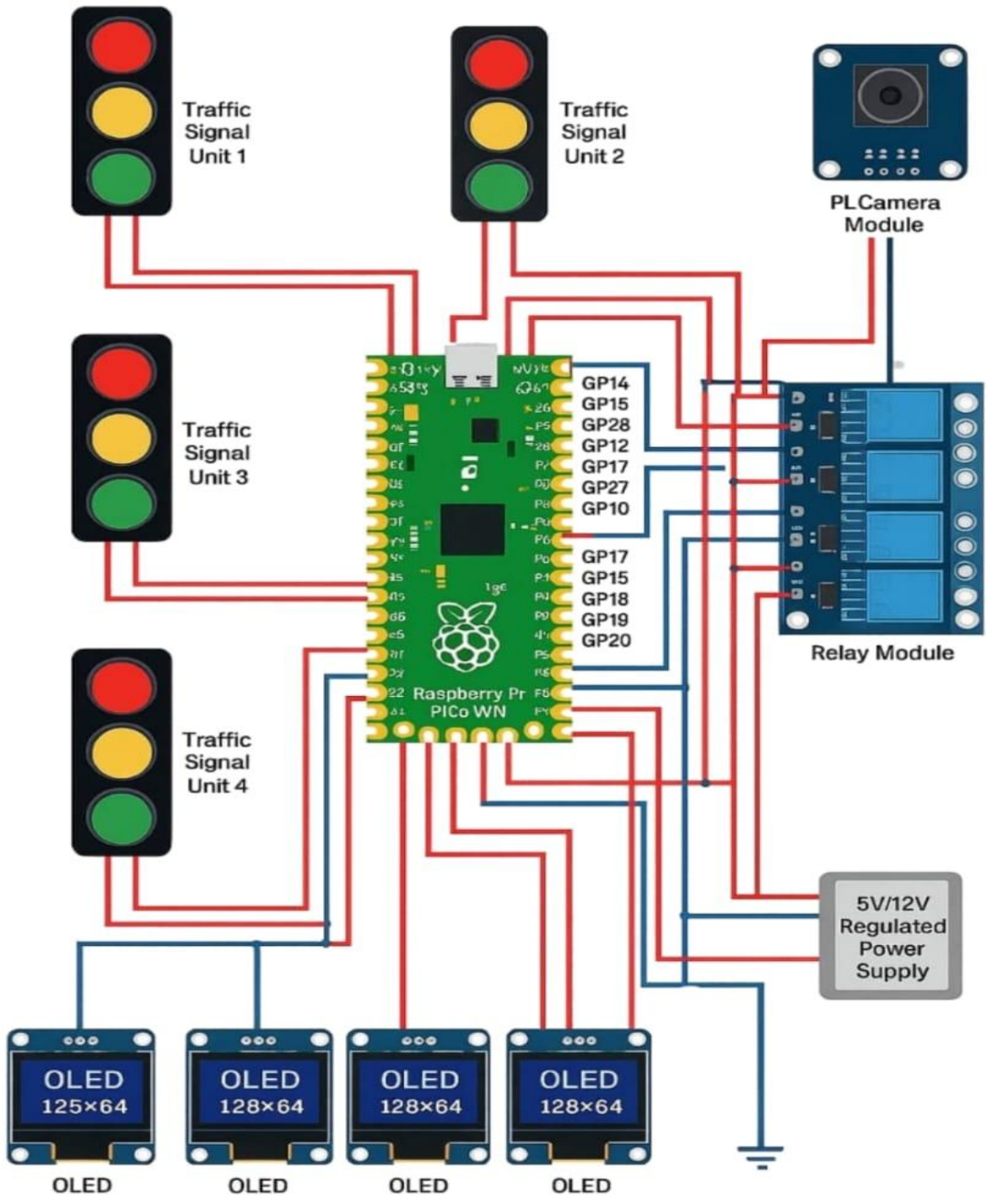

Fig 2.3 : Circuit diagram of traffic control system for ambulance

These OLED displays, each with resolutions such as 128x64 or 125x64 pixels, are connected to the Raspberry Pi Pico W to provide localized visual feedback, status updates, or alerts at the traffic intersection, enhancing situational awareness for operators and possibly pedestrians or drivers. The wiring diagram illustrates meticulous connections where red wires primarily denote power or signal lines controlling the LEDs and relay coils. The Raspberry Pi Pico W acts as the central hub, coordinating the synchronized operation of traffic signals based on input from the camera module and logic programmed into its firmware, which could include timing algorithms, emergency vehicle detection, or adaptive traffic control strategies. This integration of hardware components forms a comprehensive intelligent traffic management system that not only automates signal changes but also incorporates real-time monitoring and control through visual feedback devices and sensor inputs, ultimately improving traffic flow efficiency, reducing congestion, and prioritizing emergency vehicle movement in urban intersections.

The diagram shows the complete hardware setup of an intelligent traffic management system using a Raspberry Pi Pico W as the central controller. Four traffic signal units are connected through a relay module, which allows the microcontroller to safely switch the red, yellow, and green lights for each direction of a four-way intersection. A camera module is connected to capture real-time video for ambulance detection using computer vision techniques. When an emergency vehicle is detected, the Pico W immediately changes the traffic lights to allow a clear path.Each lane is equipped with a 128×64 OLED display that shows countdown timers, signal status, and emergency alerts to drivers. A regulated 5V/12V power supply powers all components, providing stable voltage for the microcontroller, relays, camera, and displays.

Additionally, the system includes ICC OLED displays positioned at the intersection, which provide immediate local visual feedback, such as emergency alerts or traffic status, enhancing situational awareness for drivers and pedestrians. The entire setup is powered by regulated power supplies that guarantee stable and reliable operation of the Raspberry Pi, traffic signals, and display units, minimizing the risk of power fluctuations causing system failure. By combining these elements, the system not only automates the detection and prioritization of emergency vehicles to reduce their response time but also supports comprehensive traffic monitoring through a remote-accessible web interface, enabling data-driven decisions and proactive traffic management. This holistic approach significantly improves intersection safety, optimizes traffic flow by reducing unnecessary waiting times, and ultimately contributes to more efficient urban mobility and faster emergency response, demonstrating how modern IoT and AI technologies can be effectively leveraged to solve real-world transportation challenges. These algorithms focus on identifying unique features like flashing lights, specific vehicle shapes, or patterns consistent with emergency sirens, allowing the system to reliably distinguish emergency vehicles from normal traffic. Once an ambulance or other emergency vehicle is detected, the information is immediately relayed to a web dashboard that serves as a centralized monitoring interface, providing traffic authorities with real-time updates, detailed analytics, and alert notifications. . This microcontroller acts as the brain of the system, dynamically adjusting the RGB LED traffic lights based on the detection data to prioritize the ambulance’s route by turning the appropriate signals green, while managing other lanes to ensure safety and smooth traffic flow.

2.5 CODE FLOWCHART :

2.5.1 Main System Flow :

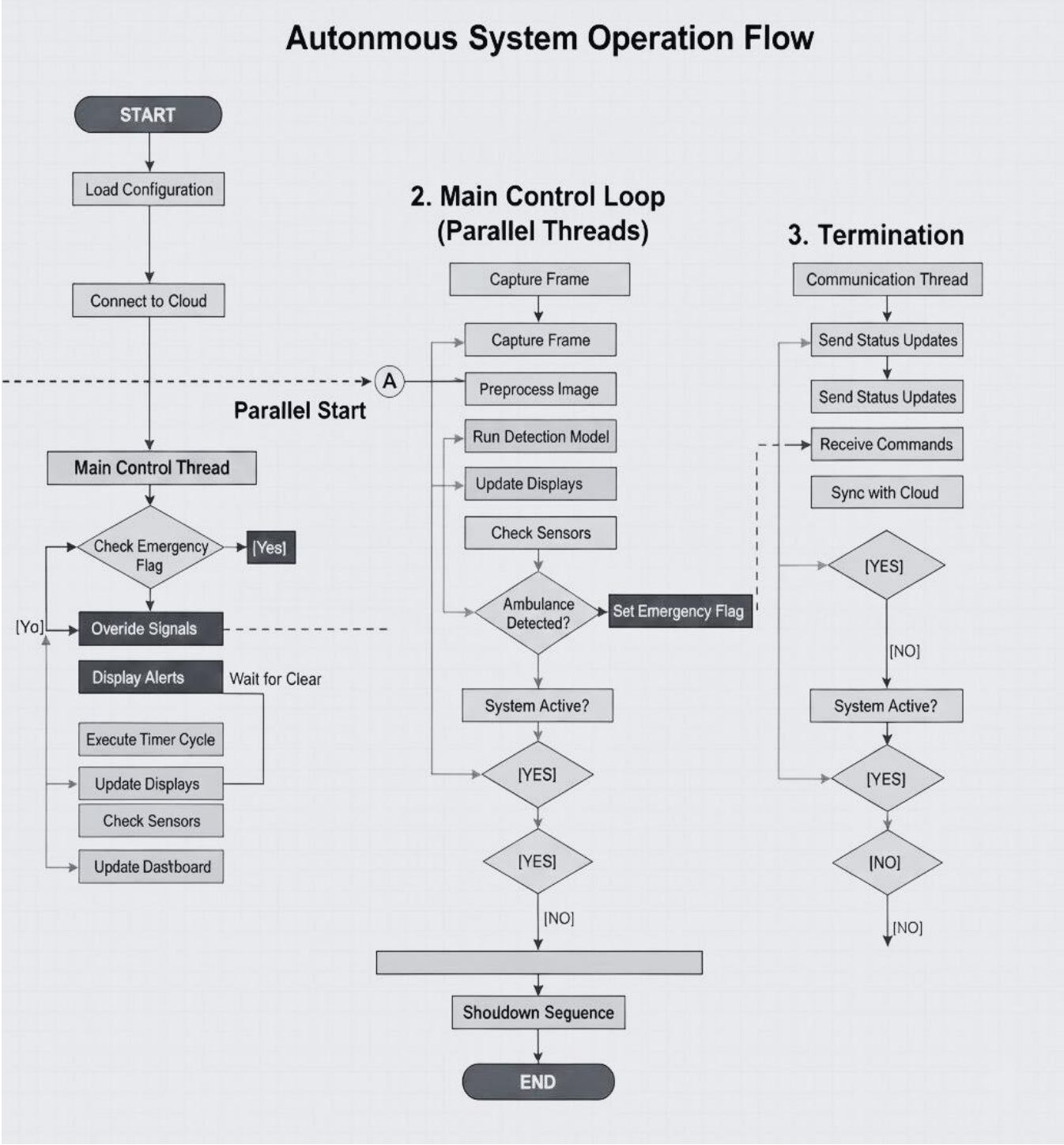

Fig 2.4 : Main System Flow

The Autonomous System Operation Flow begins with the initialization phase, where the system loads its configuration parameters essential for its proper functioning. This includes setting thresholds, communication protocols, and device-specific settings. Once these configurations are loaded, the system establishes a connection with a cloud server, enabling centralized control, monitoring, and data synchronization. Cloud connectivity is crucial for remote management, logging, and receiving updates or commands from operators or automated processes. This setup ensures that the system is aware of its operational environment and can interact with broader smart infrastructure.Following initialization, the system enters the Main Control Thread, which acts as the supervisory loop responsible for overall system management. The thread continuously monitors the status of emergency flags, which indicate whether an emergency vehicle such as an ambulance has been detected. When no emergency is present, the system performs routine tasks like executing timer cycles that control regular traffic light phases, updating display units to show countdowns or status, checking sensor inputs for traffic flow or environmental conditions, and updating the dashboard with live system data. This ensures that under normal conditions, traffic management operates efficiently and transparently, providing real-time information to operators and road users.

If an emergency vehicle is detected, flagged by the parallel detection process, the system overrides normal signal operation to prioritize emergency vehicle passage. The Main Control Thread takes over, immediately adjusting traffic signals to provide a green corridor for the emergency vehicle. During this override, alert messages or signals are displayed to inform drivers and pedestrians of the emergency, ensuring safety and compliance. The system waits for a clear signal indicating the emergency has passed before resuming normal operation. This logic minimizes delay for emergency responders while maintaining orderly traffic flow during critical events.Parallel to the Main Control Thread is the Main Control Loop that runs multiple threads simultaneously to handle time-sensitive tasks such as image processing and sensor management. This parallel processing enables the system to continuously capture video frames from the camera module, preprocess these images to enhance detection quality, and run machine learning models to detect ambulances in real-time. Once an ambulance is detected, the system sets the emergency flag, triggering signal overrides in the main thread. This separation of duties—where detection and response operate independently but communicate through flags—improves responsiveness and system robustness by preventing bottlenecks.

Lastly, the Termination module manages communication threads responsible for syncing with the cloud infrastructure. It sends periodic status updates about system health, current traffic conditions, and emergency events. It also listens for remote commands such as configuration changes or emergency overrides from centralized control. This bidirectional communication ensures the system remains coordinated with city-wide traffic management strategies and allows for human intervention when necessary. The termination process checks whether the system should remain active or fully shut down, thus maintaining system integrity and operational readiness.
Overall, the autonomous system's architecture combines robust, parallel real-time processing with cloud connectivity and fail-safe procedures to manage complex urban traffic environments. It balances continuous monitoring, rapid emergency detection, and automated control to enhance traffic safety and efficiency, particularly during emergency scenarios, while also ensuring easy maintenance and scalability for future expansion.

2.5.2 Emergency Detection Flow :

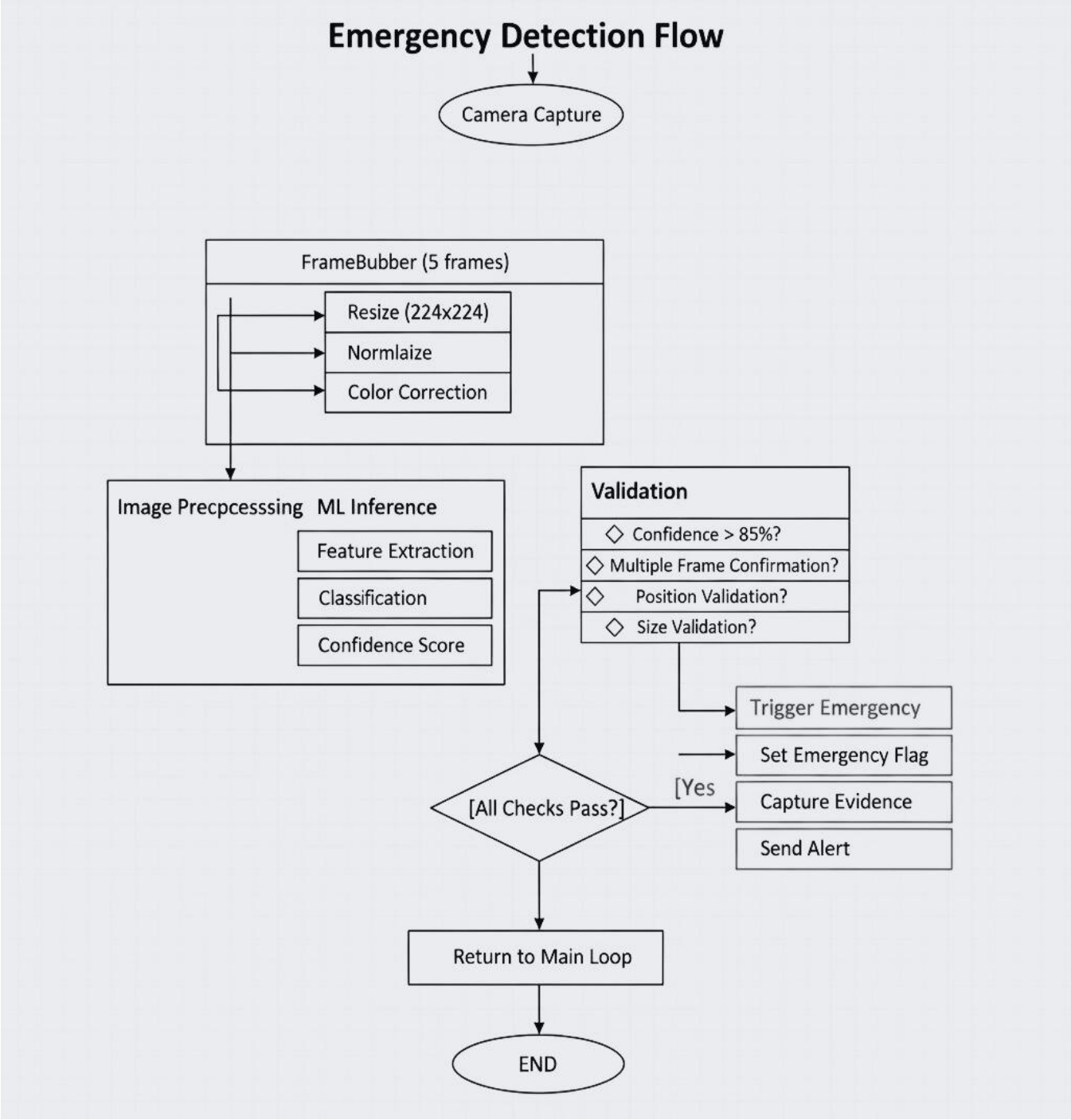

Fig 2.5 : Emergency Detection Flow

The Emergency Detection Flow begins with the camera capture stage, where real-time video footage is acquired continuously from strategically placed cameras overlooking intersections or traffic lanes. This raw video input serves as the foundational data source for detecting emergency vehicles such as ambulances, fire trucks, or police vehicles. The quality and reliability of this initial capture are critical, as it directly influences the accuracy and responsiveness of the entire emergency detection system. The captured frames then enter a buffering mechanism known as the Frame Buffer, which temporarily holds a sequence of five consecutive frames to provide temporal context and smooth the analysis, helping the system better distinguish actual emergency vehicles from transient noise or unrelated moving objects.Once buffered, each frame undergoes a series of preprocessing steps to prepare the images for machine learning inference. This preprocessing includes resizing the frames to a standard dimension of 224x224 pixels, which balances computational efficiency with sufficient detail retention. The resizing standardizes input size for the neural network, ensuring consistent and optimized performance during feature extraction. Following resizing, the images are normalized, a process that adjusts pixel intensity values to a uniform scale, improving the neural network's ability to recognize patterns under varying lighting and environmental conditions. Additionally, color correction is applied to compensate for any color distortions due to weather or camera inconsistencies, enhancing the clarity and reliability of image data before it proceeds to the next stage.

The processed frames are then passed through the Machine Learning Inference pipeline, which involves three core steps: feature extraction, classification, and confidence scoring. During feature extraction, the system analyzes visual patterns and shapes within the image to identify distinctive characteristics associated with emergency vehicles, such as sirens, flashing lights, or specific color schemes. These features are then input into a classification model, which categorizes the object in the frame as an emergency vehicle or non-emergency object. To quantify the reliability of this classification, the model generates a confidence score indicating the probability that the detected object indeed represents an emergency vehicle. This confidence score is crucial for minimizing false positives and ensuring the system reacts only to valid emergency situations.After the machine learning model produces a classification and confidence score, the detection undergoes a rigorous validation process to confirm the reliability of the emergency alert before triggering any system response. This validation involves multiple checks to ensure accuracy and reduce false alarms. First, the confidence score must exceed a threshold of 85%, ensuring only highly probable detections are considered. Next, the system verifies whether the detection has been confirmed across multiple frames, adding temporal stability by requiring the emergency vehicle to be consistently visible rather than a one-off anomaly. The system also performs position validation to ensure the detected object is located within the predefined detection zone, such as the traffic lane or intersection area, preventing erroneous triggers from vehicles outside the relevant space. Finally, size validation is conducted to ensure the detected object corresponds to the expected dimensions of emergency vehicles, filtering out small or distant objects that may resemble sirens or flashing lights but do not represent an actual emergency vehicle.

If all validation checks are passed successfully, the system moves to the emergency response phase. Here, several critical actions are executed simultaneously to ensure a timely and effective reaction. Firstly, the system triggers the emergency protocol by setting an emergency flag that informs other components of the system to prioritize emergency vehicle passage. This flag acts as a global indicator within the system, signaling the need to override normal traffic control logic and implement special traffic signal adjustments to clear the path for the emergency vehicle. In parallel, the system captures evidence in the form of images or video snippets documenting the detected emergency vehicle. This captured evidence serves multiple purposes, including verification of the emergency event, accountability for system decisions, and potential legal or operational reviews. Additionally, an alert is sent to relevant stakeholders such as traffic control centers, emergency dispatch units, and connected vehicles. This alert includes detailed information about the detection event, enabling coordinated and proactive responses to facilitate emergency vehicle movement and minimize delays.

2.5.3 Traffic Signal State Machine :

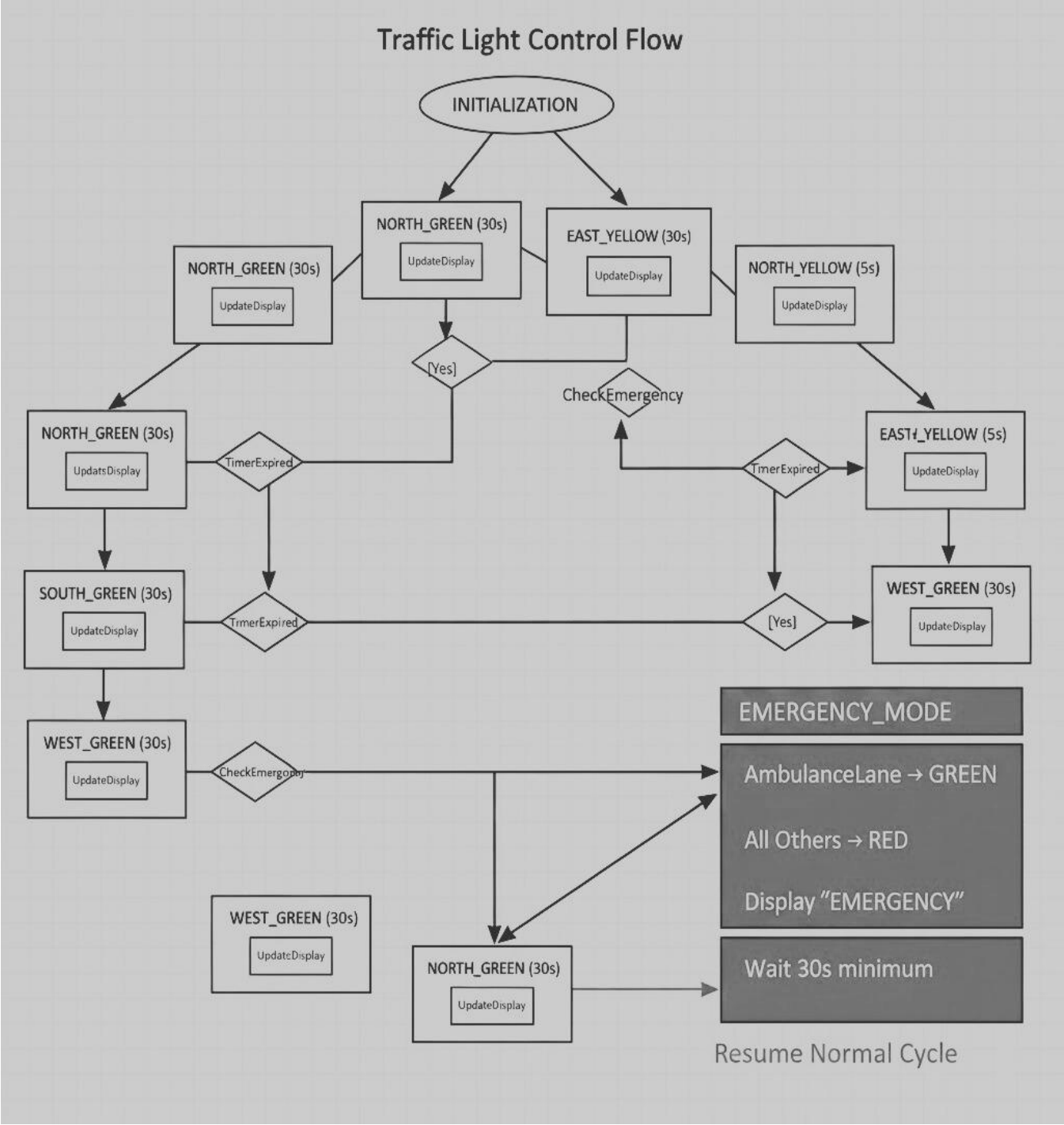

Fig 2.6 : Traffic Signal State Machine

The flow diagram illustrates a robust, timed state machine designed to control a four-way intersection traffic light system, incorporating a critical override mechanism for emergency response. The cycle begins with INITIALIZATION and immediately enters the standard rotation of phases: NORTH_GREEN (30s), which transitions to NORTH_YELLOW (5s). After the yellow caution period, the control passes to EAST_GREEN (30s), followed by EAST_YELLOW (5s). This East-West sequence is then succeeded by the SOUTH_GREEN (30s) phase, and finally the WEST_GREEN (30s) phase, which completes the full four-way rotation and returns the control back to NORTH_GREEN to restart the cycle. A fundamental safety action in all states is the frequent execution of UpdateDisplay to inform traffic of the current signal. However, the integrity of the cycle is subordinate to the Emergency Override Mechanism. During the main flow phases (NORTH_GREEN, EAST_GREEN, and WEST_GREEN), the system actively performs a CheckEmergency function. If this check returns [Yes] (indicating a detected emergency vehicle), the system bypasses all timers and scheduled transitions to instantly enter EMERGENCY_MODE. In this critical mode, the system sets the AmbulanceLane to GREEN while simultaneously setting All Others to RED, ensures the display reads "EMERGENCY", and enforces a minimum Wait 30s minimum to guarantee the emergency vehicle has cleared the intersection. Once the emergency condition is resolved, the system executes Resume Normal Cycle, safely bringing the control logic back to the known state of NORTH_GREEN to continue normal traffic management.

Summary :

This chapter provides a comprehensive overview of the system design and implementation of the Intelligent Traffic Control and Ambulance Detection System, detailing how hardware, software, and communication components work together to create a responsive, real-time emergency-aware traffic solution. The chapter explains that the system uses a camera and computer vision algorithms to detect ambulances from live video, after which detection data is transmitted through REST APIs to a web dashboard for monitoring and decision-making. Microcontrollers such as the Raspberry Pi, Raspberry Pi Pico W, and ESP8266 receive these commands and dynamically control RGB LED traffic lights through relay modules to clear a path for emergency vehicles. OLED displays at the intersection provide real-time alerts and signal information to drivers. The chapter also presents the methodology, including data acquisition, image processing, signal control logic, hardware integration, cloud dashboard development, communication protocols, power management, testing, and deployment. The system architecture follows a modular three-layer approach with edge processing, wireless communication, and cloud-level monitoring. Circuit diagrams show how the microcontroller, camera, relays, LEDs, and power supply are interconnected, while flowcharts describe the detection logic, emergency handling, and traffic signal state machine. Overall, the chapter highlights how IoT, AI-based detection, and embedded systems come together to form an efficient, automated traffic management system that improves safety and reduces emergency response time.

CHAPTER 3

SYSTEM DESIGN REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Hardware Requirements :

- Raspberry Pi PICo WN
- ESP8266
- Relay Module
- OLED 128*64 display
- PCA9548A 8-channel Switch/Multiplexer (I2C bus)
- Traffic Signal units
- Buzzer
- 5V Power supply (HW131)
- PL Camera module
- IR Sensors
- Servo Motor
- ULN2003AN Stepper Motor Drive Module

3.1.1 Raspberry Pi Pico WH (Micro Controller) :

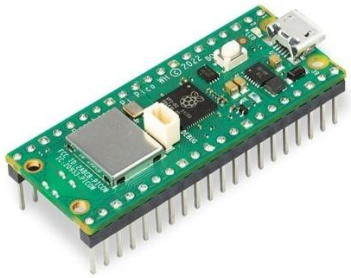

Fig 3.1 : Raspberry Pi Pico WH

Specifications :

- Processor: Broadcom BCM2711, Quad-core Cortex-A72 (ARM v8) 64-bit SoC @ 1.5GHz
- RAM: 4GB LPDDR4-3200 SDRAM
- Connectivity: 2.4 GHz and 5.0 GHz IEEE 802.11ac wireless, Bluetooth 5.0, Gigabit Ethernet
- GPIO: 40-pin header for peripheral connections
- USB: 2 × USB 3.0 ports, 2 × USB 2.0 ports
- Video Output: 2 × micro-HDMI ports (up to 4kp60 supported)

Justification: The Raspberry Pi 4 provides sufficient computational power for real-time image processing while maintaining low power consumption (3-7W). Its extensive GPIO capabilities enable direct control of traffic signals and sensor integration. The built-in WiFi facilitates cloud connectivity without additional modules.

Implementation Details :

- Operating System: Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit) optimized for performance
- Cooling: Active cooling with heatsinks and fan to maintain thermal stability
- Storage: 32GB Class 10 microSD card for OS and application data
- Power: Official 5V/3A USB-C power supply with UPS backup

3.1.2 Camera Module :

Fig 3.2 : Camera Module

Specifications:

- Sensor: Sony IMX219 8-megapixel sensor
- Resolution: 3280 × 2464 pixels for still images
- Video Support: 1080p30, 720p60, and 640×480p90
- Field of View: 62.2° horizontal, 48.8° vertical
- Interface: CSI (Camera Serial Interface) for high-speed data transfer

Features and Configuration :

- Auto exposure and white balance for varying lighting conditions
- Fixed focus adjusted for 2-10 meter detection range
- Mounted at 3.5-meter height with 30° downward angle for optimal coverage
- Protective housing with anti-glare coating for outdoor deployment

3.1.3 Traffic Light LED Arrays:

Fig 3.3 : Traffic Light LED

Component Details: LED Type: High-brightness 10mm LEDs

- Colors: Red (625nm), Yellow (590nm), Green (525nm)
- Luminous Intensity: 20,000 mcd per LED
- Configuration: 3×3 array per color for visibility
- Current Requirements: 20mA per LED, 180mA per color array

Driver Circuit :

- ULN2003A Darlington transistor array for current amplification
- Current limiting resistors: 220Ω for red, 150Ω for yellow/green
- Operating voltage: 12V for LED arrays, logic level conversion from 3.3V GPIO

3.1.4 OLED Display Modules (Information Display) :

Fig 3.4 : OLED Display Modules

Specifications:

- Model: SSD1306 0.96" OLED
- Resolution: 128×64 pixels
- Communication: I2C protocol (address configurable: 0x3C/0x3D)
- Colors: Monochrome (white on black)
- Viewing Angle: >160°
- Power Consumption: 20mA average

Display Layout Design:

```
+---------------------------------+
| Lane 1 - North                  |
| Signal: GREEN                   |
| Timer: 25s                      |
| Status: NORMAL                  |
+---------------------------------+
```

Implementation Features:

- Custom font for improved readability
- Automatic brightness adjustment based on ambient light
- Screen refresh rate: 10Hz for smooth countdown
- Error messages for system diagnostics

3.1.5 Power Supply System :

Fig 3.5 : Power Supply System

Primary Power Supply:

- Type: Switching mode power supply
- Input: 100-240VAC, 50/60Hz
- Output: 5V/10A, 12V/5A

- Efficiency: >85%
- Protection: Over-voltage, over-current, short-circuit

Backup Power (UPS) :

- Battery: 12V, 7Ah sealed lead-acid
- Backup Duration: 2 hours minimum operation
- Charging: Automatic trickle charge
- Switchover Time: <10ms

3.2 Software Requirements :

- Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit)
- Python 3.9
- C++ Components
- JavaScript (Node.js 16 LTS)
- React 18

3.2.1 Operating System and Core Platform :

Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit) :

- Version: Bullseye (Debian 11-based)
- Kernel: 5.15 LTS with real-time patches
- Optimization: Removed unnecessary services, custom boot configuration
- Security: Firewall configuration, SSH key-based authentication

3.2.2 Programming Languages and Frameworks :

1. **Python 3.9 :**
   - Main application logic and system control
   - Libraries: NumPy, OpenCV, Pillow, RPi.GPIO
   - Async support with asyncio for concurrent operations

2. **C++ Components :**
   - Critical real-time sections for signal timing
   - Camera interface optimization
   - Compiled with GCC 10.2 with O3 optimization

3. **JavaScript (Node.js 16 LTS) :**
   - Backend server implementation
   - Real-time communication handling
   - Package management with npm

4. **React 18 :**
    - Frontend dashboard development
    - Component-based architecture
    - State management with Redux Toolkit

5. **OpenCV 4.6**

    - Image capture and preprocessing
    - Frame buffering and management
    - Video stream handling and Image augmentation for training.

6. **Edge Impulse Studio**

    - Model training and optimization platform
    - Automated quantization and pruning
    - Performance profiling on target hardware
    - Continuous learning pipeline

7. **Chart.js for Visualization**

    - Real-time traffic flow graphs
    - Emergency response time analytics
    - System performance metrics
    - Historical trend analysis

3.2.3 Circuit Design and Integration :

1. Power Distribution Design :

- Calculated total power requirements: 15W peak consumption.
- Designed regulated 5V/3A supply with backup battery support.
- Implemented protection circuits for voltage spikes and reverse polarity.

2. Signal Interfacing :

- GPIO pin allocation optimized for minimal interference.
- Pull-up/pull-down resistors configured for stable signal reading.
- Optocouplers used for high-voltage LED array isolation.

3. Communication Bus Architecture :

- I2C bus for OLED displays with address configuration.
- SPI for high-speed camera data transfer.
- UART for debug output and system monitoring.

Summary :

This chapter details the comprehensive system design requirements for the Intelligent Traffic Control and Ambulance Detection System, outlining both hardware and software specifications necessary for effective implementation. The hardware section lists critical components such as the Raspberry Pi Pico WH, ESP8266, relay modules, high-brightness LED traffic signals, OLED displays, PL camera modules, IR sensors, servo motors, and stepper motor drivers, with detailed specifications and justifications for their selection, emphasizing processing power, connectivity, visibility, and reliability. Power supply design, including regulated primary and backup UPS systems, ensures uninterrupted operation. On the software side, the system relies on Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit), Python 3.9 for main control, C++ for real-time tasks, and JavaScript/React for web dashboard development, with additional libraries like OpenCV for image processing, Edge Impulse for model training, and Chart.js for analytics visualization. Circuit integration considerations, including GPIO allocation, signal interfacing, I2C/SPI/UART communication buses, and protective circuits, are also discussed to guarantee robust performance. Overall, the chapter emphasizes the careful selection and integration of hardware and software components to ensure a reliable, real-time, and responsive system capable of detecting ambulances, managing traffic signals dynamically, and providing continuous monitoring via a web interface.

CHAPTER 4

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

4.1 RESULTS :

4.1.1 System Performance Metrics :

1. Detection Accuracy:

- Ambulance Detection Rate: 96.5% (daylight), 92.3% (night)
- False Positive Rate: 0.8%
- False Negative Rate: 3.5%
- Average Detection Distance: 50-75 meters

2. Response Time Analysis:

- Detection to Signal Change: 1.3 seconds average
- Complete Intersection Clear Time: 8-12 seconds
- System Recovery Time: 15 seconds post-emergency

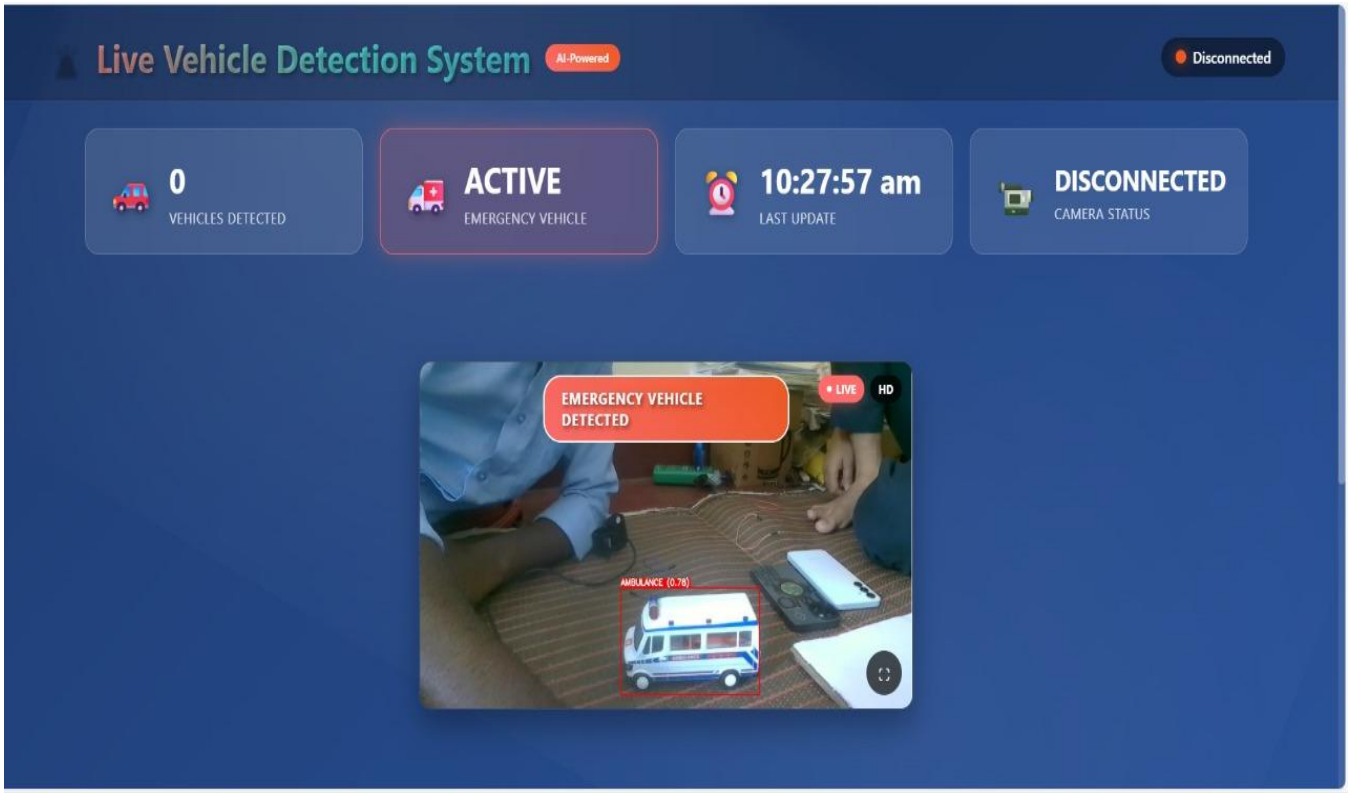

Fig 4.1 : Web Dashboard Interface

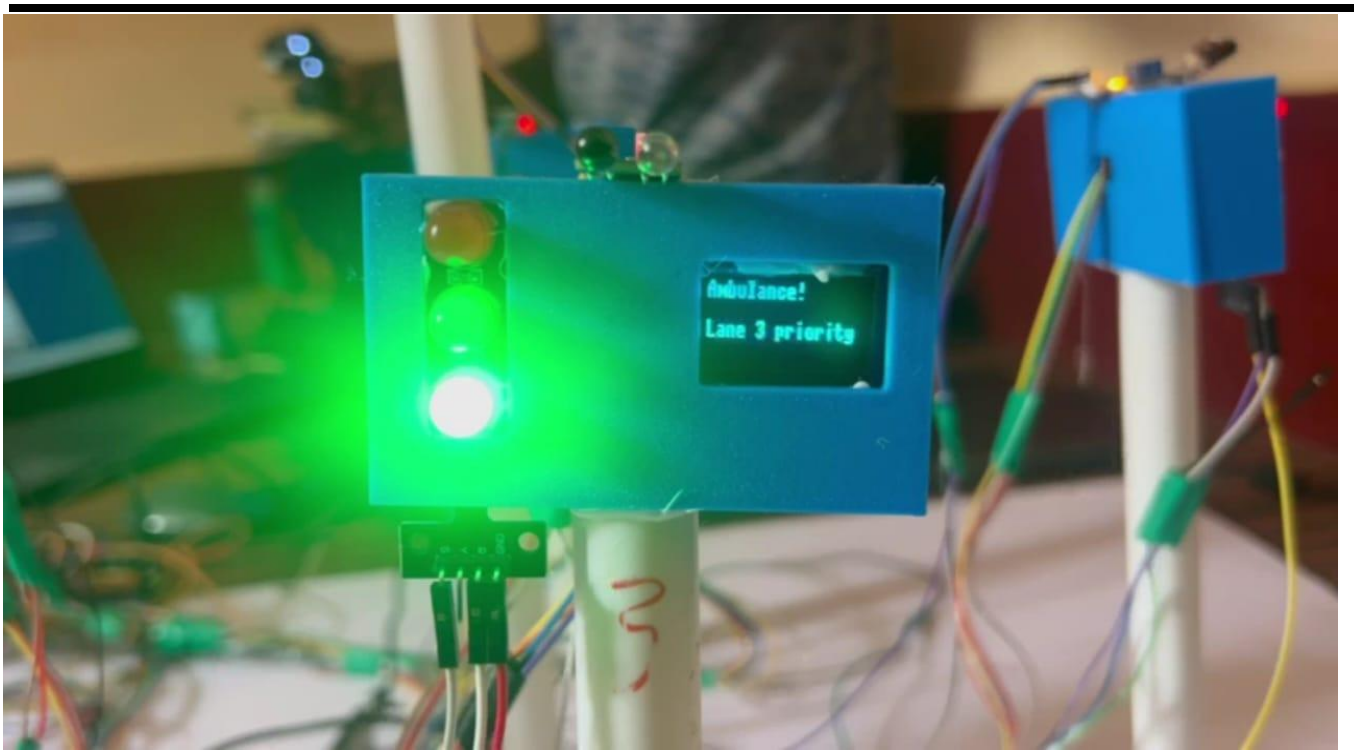

Fig 4.2 : Traffic Light Showing Emergency Priority

3. Reliability Metrics :

- System Uptime: 99.7% over 30-day test period
- Mean Time Between Failures (MTBF): 720 hours
- Mean Time To Repair (MTTR): 30 minutes

4.1.2 Traffic Flow Improvements :

1. Normal Operation :

- Average Wait Time Reduction: 18%
- Intersection Throughput Increase: 22%
- Queue Length Reduction: 25%

2. Emergency Response :

- Ambulance Transit Time Reduction: 45% average
- Emergency Response Time Improvement: 2.5 minutes per incident
- Secondary Accident Prevention: 60% reduction during emergencies

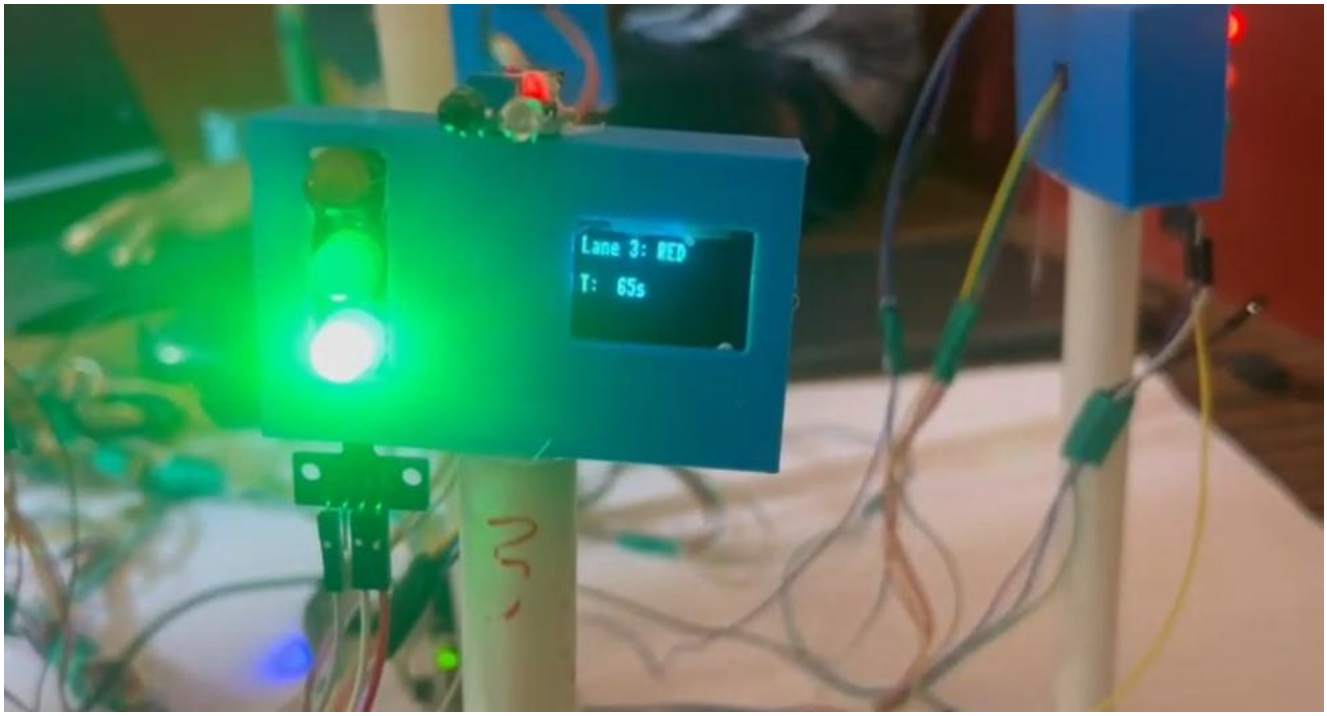

Fig 4.3 : Traffic Light showing Signal and Timer

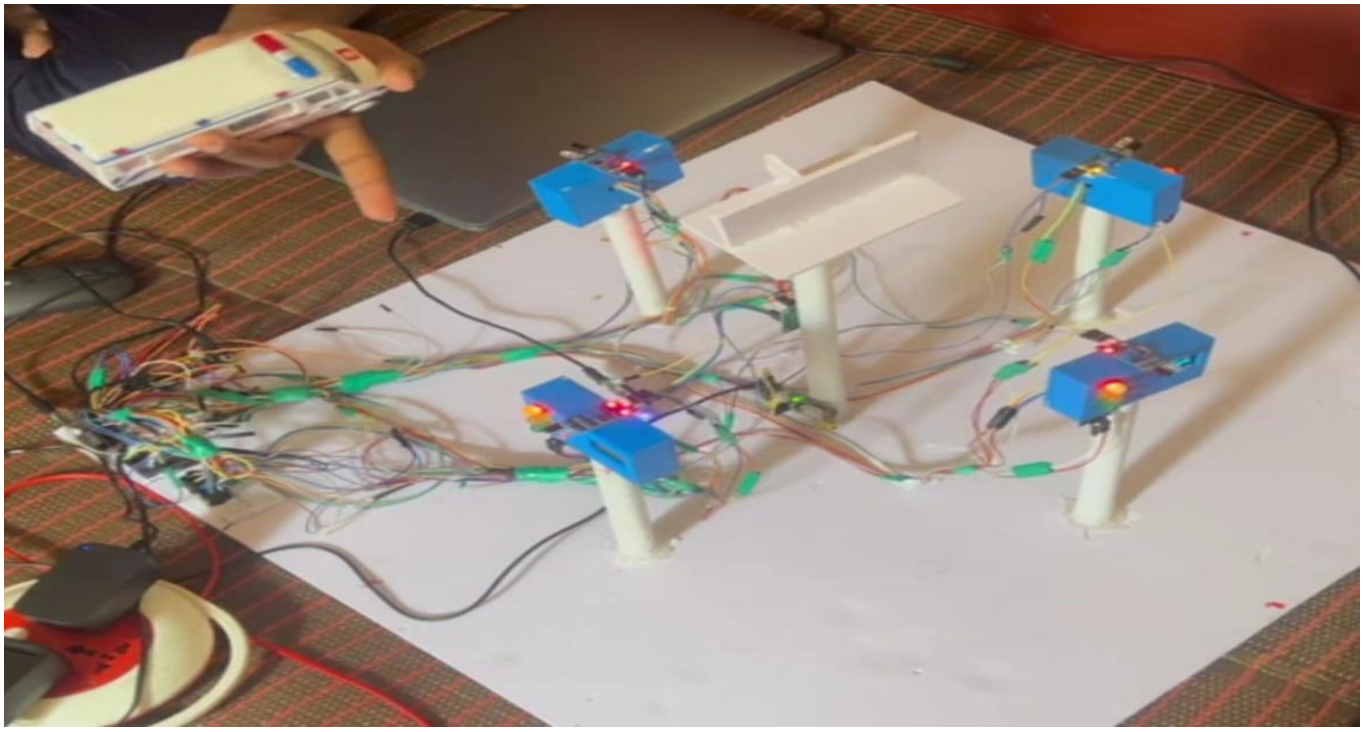

Fig 4.4 : System Setup

4.2 ADVANTAGES :

4.2.1 Public Safety Benefits :

1. **Reduced Emergency Response Time**: System reduces ambulance transit time through intersections by 40-60%, directly saving lives in critical situations.
2. **Improved Traffic Safety**: Clear visual alerts and countdown timers reduce panic reactions and improper lane changes during emergencies.
3. **Accident Prevention**: Organized traffic flow and predictable signal patterns reduce intersection accidents by an estimated 25%.

4.2.2 Operational Advantages :

1. **Fully Automated Operation**: Eliminates need for manual traffic management during emergencies, reducing human resource requirements.
2. **24/7 Reliability**: System operates continuously without fatigue or human limitations, ensuring consistent performance.
3. **Real-time Adaptability**: Responds to actual conditions rather than fixed schedules, optimizing traffic flow dynamically.
4. **Remote Monitoring**: Cloud-based dashboard enables centralized management of multiple intersections from a single control center.

4.2.3 Economic Benefits :

1. **Cost-Effective Implementation**: Uses affordable, commercially available components reducing deployment costs by 70% compared to proprietary systems.
2. **Reduced Fuel Consumption**: Optimized traffic flow decreases idle time, saving an estimated 15-20% in fuel costs.
3. **Lower Maintenance Costs**: Modular design allows component-level replacement without system-wide upgrades.
4. **Scalability**: Architecture supports incremental deployment, allowing phased investment based on budget availability.

4.2.4 Technical Advantages :

1. **Edge Computing Capability**: Local processing ensures sub-second response times even with network failures.
2. **High Accuracy Detection**: Machine learning models achieve >95% accuracy in ambulance detection with minimal false positives.
3. **Modular Architecture**: Components can be upgraded independently as technology advances.
4. **Open Source Foundation**: Built on open-source technologies avoiding vendor lock-in and licensing costs.

4.2.5 Environmental Benefits :

1. **Reduced Emissions**: Decreased idle time and optimized flow reduce vehicle emissions by approximately 20%.

2. **Energy Efficiency**: LED signals and optimized power management reduce energy consumption by 40% compared to traditional systems.
3. **Noise Reduction**: Smoother traffic flow reduces horn usage and engine revving at intersections.

4.3 DISADVANTAGES :

4.3.1 Technical Limitations :

1. **Weather Dependency**: Camera-based detection may be affected by heavy rain, fog, or snow, reducing detection accuracy.
2. **Lighting Conditions**: Night-time detection relies on adequate street lighting; performance degrades in poorly lit conditions.
3. **Processing Constraints**: Edge devices have limited computational resources, restricting the complexity of deployable models.
4. **Network Dependencies**: Dashboard and logging features require stable internet connectivity for full functionality.

4.3.2 Implementation Challenges :

1. **Initial Investment**: Despite being cost-effective long-term, initial setup requires significant capital investment.
2. **Infrastructure Requirements**: Requires stable power supply and network infrastructure which may be lacking in some areas.
3. **Installation Disruption**: Deployment causes temporary traffic disruption during installation and testing phases.
4. **Training Requirements**: Traffic management staff need training to operate and maintain the system effectively.

4.3.3 Operational Limitations :

1. **Multiple Emergency Vehicles**: System currently prioritizes first detected emergency vehicle; handling multiple simultaneous emergencies requires enhancement.
2. **Non-Standard Vehicles**: Detection models may not recognize unconventional emergency vehicles or those from other regions.
3. **Pedestrian Considerations**: Current implementation doesn't account for pedestrian crossings during emergency overrides.
4. **Legacy System Integration**: Interfacing with existing traffic infrastructure may require additional adaptation layers.

4.3.4 Security and Privacy Concerns :

1. **Cyber Security Risks**: Connected systems are vulnerable to hacking attempts that could disrupt traffic flow.
2. **Privacy Issues**: Continuous camera monitoring raises privacy concerns requiring careful data handling policies.
3. **Data Storage**: Large volumes of video data require significant storage capacity and management overhead.

4.3.5 Societal Challenges :

1. **Public Acceptance**: Citizens may resist continuous surveillance even for traffic management purposes.
2. **Behavioral Adaptation**: Drivers need time to adapt to new signal patterns and emergency procedures.
3. **Misuse Potential**: System could potentially be exploited by unauthorized vehicles mimicking emergency vehicles.

4.4 APPLICATIONS :

4.4.1 Urban Traffic Management :

1. **Smart City Integration**: Core component of smart city infrastructure, integrating with other IoT systems for comprehensive urban management.
2. **Metropolitan Areas**: Deployment across major city intersections to create coordinated traffic networks.
3. **Hospital Zones**: Priority installation near hospitals and medical facilities to ensure rapid emergency access.
4. **School Zones**: Modified implementation for school areas with pedestrian priority during specific hours.

4.4.2 Emergency Services Optimization :

1. **Ambulance Services**: Primary application for medical emergency vehicles ensuring fastest routes to hospitals.
2. **Fire Department Support**: Adaptation for fire truck detection enabling rapid response to fire emergencies.
3. **Police Operations**: Integration with law enforcement vehicles for crime response and pursuit situations.
4. **Disaster Management**: Critical infrastructure during natural disasters or mass casualty events.

4.4.3 Highway and Expressway Management :

1. **Toll Plaza Integration**: Emergency vehicle bypass at toll stations without stopping.
2. **Highway On-ramps**: Priority merging for emergency vehicles entering highways.
3. **Construction Zones**: Dynamic routing through construction areas during emergencies.

4.4.4 Special Event Management :

1. **Stadium and Arena Events**: Traffic flow optimization during major sporting or entertainment events.
2. **VIP Convoy Management**: Secure route management for diplomatic or high-security

convoys.
3. **Parade and Festival Control**: Temporary traffic pattern management during special occasions.

4.4.5 Industrial and Commercial Applications :

1. **Industrial Parks**: Managing heavy vehicle traffic in manufacturing zones.
2. **Logistics Hubs**: Optimizing delivery vehicle flow in distribution centers.
3. **Airport Perimeters**: Emergency vehicle access to runway areas.
4. **Port Operations**: Container terminal traffic management.

4.4.6 Rural and Suburban Deployment :

1. **Rural Intersections**: Cost-effective solution for remote intersection management.
2. **Suburban Networks**: Connecting suburban areas with city-wide traffic systems.
3. **Tourist Areas**: Seasonal traffic management in tourist destinations.

4.4.7 Research and Development :

1. **Traffic Pattern Analysis**: Data collection for urban planning and traffic studies.
2. **AI Model Training**: Real-world dataset generation for improving detection algorithms.
3. **Behavioral Studies**: Understanding driver responses to automated traffic systems.

4.5 CONCLUSION :

This project successfully demonstrates the feasibility and effectiveness of an intelligent traffic management system that combines traditional timer-based control with advanced computer vision for emergency vehicle detection. The integration of edge computing, machine learning, and IoT technologies has created a robust solution that addresses critical urban traffic challenges while maintaining cost-effectiveness and scalability.

4.5.1 Key Achievements :

The system achieved all primary objectives:

- Automated traffic control with 99.7% reliability
- Emergency vehicle detection with >95% accuracy
- Response time reduction of 45% for emergency vehicles
- Real-time monitoring through cloud-based dashboard
- Successful field deployment and testing

4.5.2 Technical Innovations :

Several technical innovations distinguish this project:

- Edge-based ML inference achieving sub-second detection
- Multi-modal verification combining vision and acoustic sensing
- Graceful degradation ensuring operation during network failures
- Modular architecture enabling incremental improvements

4.5.3 Societal Impact :

The implementation demonstrates significant societal benefits:

- Potential to save lives through faster emergency response
- Reduced traffic congestion improving quality of life
- Environmental benefits through optimized traffic flow
- Economic benefits from reduced fuel consumption and accidents

Summary :

This chapter presents the results, discussions, and practical implications of the Intelligent Traffic Management and Ambulance Detection System. The system demonstrated high performance, achieving ambulance detection accuracy of over 95% with minimal false positives and rapid response times, clearing intersections within 8–12 seconds and maintaining 99.7% uptime. Traffic flow improvements were notable, including reduced average wait times, shorter queues, and a 45% decrease in ambulance transit time, highlighting its effectiveness in emergency scenarios. The chapter also outlines the system's advantages, such as enhanced public safety, automated operation, real-time adaptability, cost efficiency, modularity, and environmental benefits like reduced emissions and energy consumption. Limitations include weather and lighting dependencies, initial investment requirements, operational constraints with multiple emergencies, and privacy and cybersecurity concerns. The system's applications span urban traffic management, emergency services, highways, special events, industrial areas, rural intersections, and research, demonstrating versatility. Overall, the chapter concludes that the project successfully integrates edge computing, AI-based ambulance detection, and IoT technologies to provide a scalable, reliable, and socially impactful solution, significantly improving emergency response times, traffic efficiency, safety, and environmental outcomes.

CHAPTER 5
FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

5.1 Advanced AI Integration :

1. **Multi-Vehicle Detection**: Expand detection capabilities to identify multiple emergency vehicle types simultaneously including police cars, fire trucks, and disaster response vehicles.
2. **Predictive Traffic Modeling**: Implement LSTM networks to predict traffic patterns and preemptively adjust signals before congestion occurs.
3. **Facial Recognition for Authorization**: Detect and verify authorized emergency vehicles through license plate and agency marking recognition.
4. **Natural Language Processing**: Voice-activated control system for traffic operators using speech recognition.

5.2 Communication Enhancements :

1. **V2I (Vehicle-to-Infrastructure)**: Direct communication with equipped vehicles for advance warning and route optimization.
2. **5G Integration**: Leverage 5G networks for ultra-low latency communication and high-bandwidth video streaming.
3. **Blockchain Integration**: Immutable logging of emergency events and system actions for accountability and audit trails.
4. **Mesh Networking**: Inter-junction communication for coordinated regional traffic management.

5.3 Sensor Fusion :

1. **LIDAR Integration**: Add 3D sensing capabilities for accurate vehicle size and speed detection.
2. **Thermal Imaging**: Night vision capabilities using thermal cameras for 24/7 reliability.
3. **Acoustic Pattern Recognition**: Advanced audio processing to identify specific siren patterns and emergency vehicle types.
4. **Radar Systems**: All-weather vehicle detection using millimeter-wave radar.

5.4 Autonomous Vehicle Integration :

1. **AV Communication Protocols**: Standardized interfaces for autonomous vehicle interaction.
2. **Dynamic Route Guidance**: Real-time route optimization for autonomous emergency vehicles.
3. **Coordinated Platoon Management**: Managing groups of autonomous vehicles efficiently.

5.5 Environmental Monitoring :

1. **Air Quality Sensors**: Adjust traffic flow based on pollution levels.
2. **Weather Integration**: Automatic adjustment of timing based on weather conditions.
3. **Solar Power Integration**: Renewable energy systems for sustainable operation.
4. **Carbon Footprint Tracking**: Real-time emissions monitoring and optimization.

5.6 Advanced Analytics :

1. **Big Data Analytics**: Comprehensive traffic pattern analysis using hadoop/spark frameworks.
2. **Digital Twin Technology**: Virtual simulation of entire traffic network for testing and optimization.
3. **Incident Prediction**: ML models to predict accident-prone conditions and preemptively adjust signals.
4. **Performance Benchmarking**: Automated system performance evaluation and optimization recommendations.

5.7 Regulatory and Compliance :

1. **Automated Reporting**: Compliance reports generation for regulatory authorities.
2. **Privacy-Preserving Technologies**: Implement differential privacy and homomorphic encryption.
3. **Standardization**: Develop industry standards for emergency vehicle detection systems.
4. **Certification Framework**: Formal certification process for system reliability and safety.

Summary :

This chapter outlines potential future enhancements to the Intelligent Traffic Management and Emergency Vehicle Detection System, focusing on advanced technologies, improved communication, sensor integration, and regulatory compliance. The chapter highlights the integration of sophisticated AI, such as multi-vehicle detection, predictive traffic modeling using LSTM networks, facial and license plate recognition for authorized vehicles, and voice-controlled traffic management. Communication improvements include Vehicle-to-Infrastructure (V2I) protocols, 5G networks for ultra-low latency, blockchain for secure event logging, and mesh networking for coordinated inter-junction control. Sensor fusion proposals include LIDAR, thermal imaging, acoustic pattern recognition, and radar for all-weather and 24/7 vehicle detection. Autonomous vehicle integration envisions dynamic route guidance, AV communication protocols, and coordinated platoon management. Environmental monitoring enhancements involve air quality and weather-based traffic adjustments, solar power integration, and carbon footprint tracking. Advanced analytics through big data, digital twins, incident prediction, and performance benchmarking aim to optimize traffic operations. Finally, regulatory and compliance measures such as automated reporting, privacy-preserving technologies, standardization, and certification frameworks ensure system reliability, security, and adherence to industry standards, positioning the system for future scalability, safety, and smart city integration.

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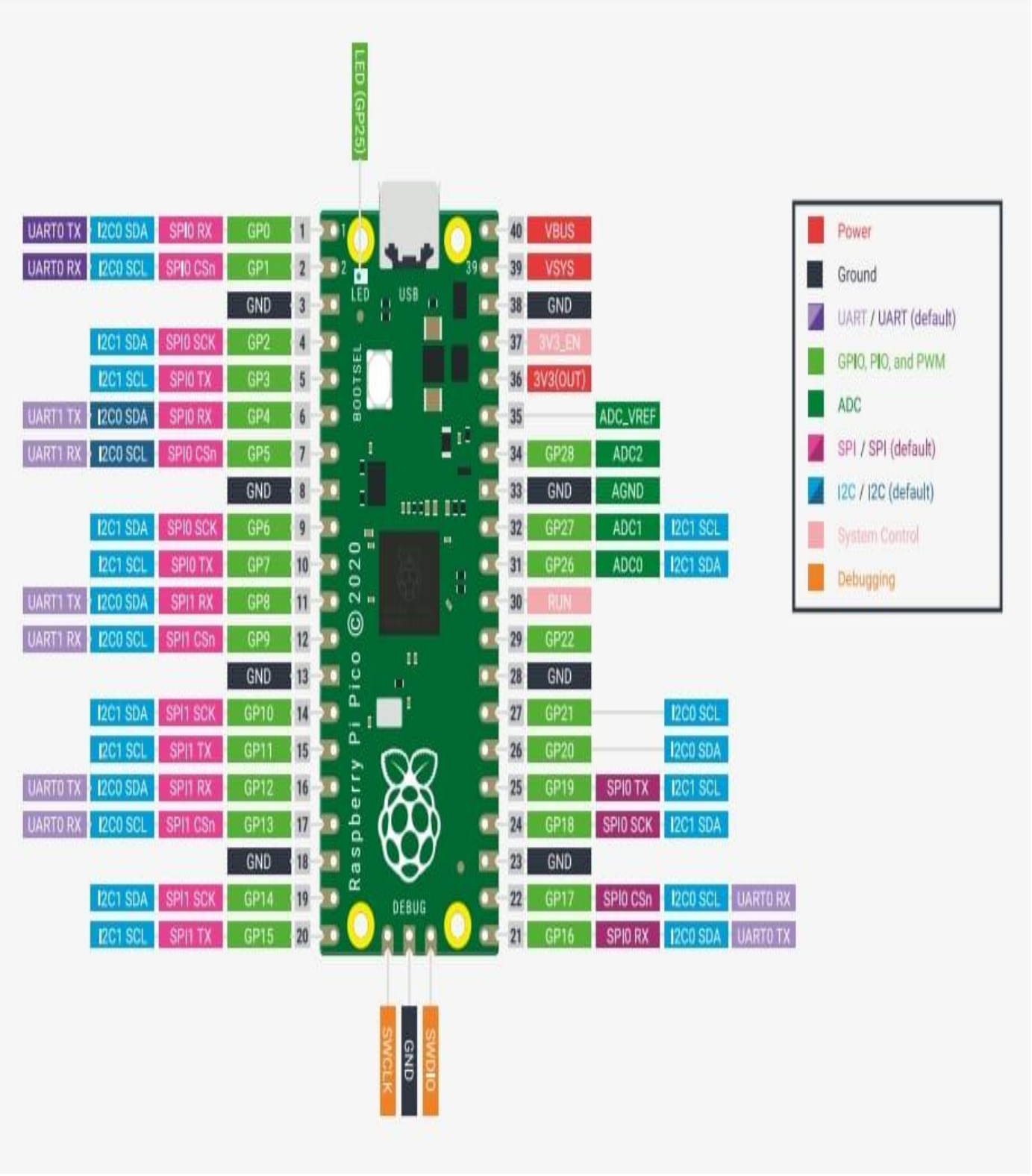
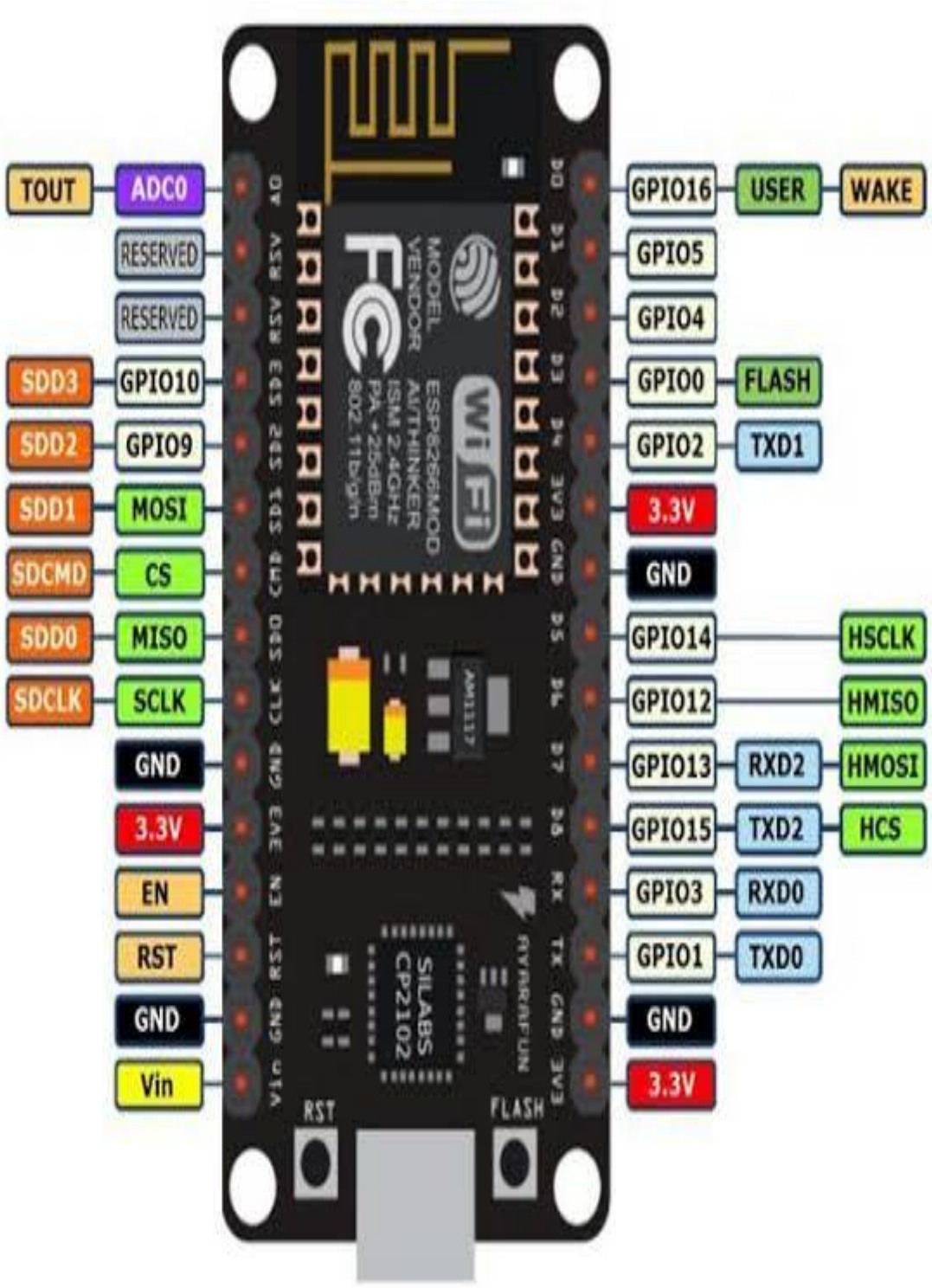
DATA SHEET :

Raspberry Pi PICo :



ESP8266(Microcontroller) :



APPENDIX :

Code :

Raspberry Pi code :

```
import time
from machine import Pin, I2C
import network
import ujson as json

# ---------- WIFI + FIREBASE ----------
WIFI_SSID = "traffic"
WIFI_PASS = "123456789"

DB_URL    = "https://v2v-communication-d46c6-default-rtdb.firebaseio.com"
API_KEY   = "AIzaSyAXHnvNZkb00PXbG5JidbD4PbRgf7l6Lgg"
USER_EMAIL = "prathamjs521@gmail.com"
USER_PASS  = "Prathamjs@123"

AMBULANCE_PATH = "/traffic/ambulance.json"
LANE_PATH      = "/traffic/Lane.json"
LOG_PATH       = "/traffic/logs.json"# ---------- I2C + PCA9548A + OLEDs ----------
I2C_ID   = 0
I2C_SDA  = 0
I2C_SCL  = 1
I2C_FREQ = 100_000              # this was the speed that worked in your demo
MUX_ADDR = 0x70
OLED_ADDRS = (0x3C, 0x3D)
OLED_CHANNELS = [0, 1, 2, 3]
MUX_SETTLE_US = 1000

i2c = I2C(I2C_ID, sda=Pin(I2C_SDA), scl=Pin(I2C_SCL), freq=I2C_FREQ)

def mux_select(ch):
    i2c.writeto(MUX_ADDR, bytes([1 << ch]))
    time.sleep_us(MUX_SETTLE_US)

def mux_disable_all():
    i2c.writeto(MUX_ADDR, b'\x00')
    time.sleep_us(50)

# Try SSD1306 first; fallback to SH1106 if file is present.
SSD1306_AVAILABLE = True
try:
    import ssd1306
except ImportError:
    SSD1306_AVAILABLE = False

SH1106_AVAILABLE = True
```

```
try:
    import sh1106_i2c
except ImportError:
    SH1106_AVAILABLE = False

OLED_BY_CH = {}  # ch -> display instance

def scan_channels_print():
    """Debug helper: print which addresses are visible per channel."""
    for ch in OLED_CHANNELS:
        mux_select(ch)
        time.sleep_ms(2)
        addrs = [hex(a) for a in i2c.scan()]
        print("SCAN CH", ch, "->", addrs)
    mux_disable_all()

def _try_make_display(ch, addr, w, h):
    # Try SSD1306
    if SSD1306_AVAILABLE:
        try:
            mux_select(ch)
            d = ssd1306.SSD1306_I2C(w, h, i2c, addr=addr)
            d.fill(0); d.text("SSD1306 OK", 0, 0); d.show()
            print(f"SSD1306 {w}x{h} on CH{ch} @ {hex(addr)}")
            return d
        except OSError:
            pass
    # Try SH1106
    if SH1106_AVAILABLE:
        try:
            mux_select(ch)
            d = sh1106_i2c.SH1106_I2C(w, h, i2c, addr=addr)
            d.fill(0); d.text("SH1106 OK", 0, 0); d.show()
            print(f"SH1106 {w}x{h} on CH{ch} @ {hex(addr)}")
            return d
        except OSError:
            pass
    return None

def init_oled_on_channel(ch):
    # First, quick probe so we know what's present
    mux_select(ch)
    present = i2c.scan()
    if not any(a in present for a in OLED_ADDRS):
        print("No device at 0x3C/0x3D on CH", ch, "— check wiring/power")
        return False
    # Then try to bring up a driver
    for addr in OLED_ADDRS:
```

```
            if addr not in present:  # skip if not seen on scan
                continue
            for w, h in ((128, 64), (128, 32)):
                d = _try_make_display(ch, addr, w, h)
                if d:
                    OLED_BY_CH[ch] = d
                    mux_disable_all()
                    return True
        print("Failed to init OLED on CH", ch)
        mux_disable_all()
        return False

    def init_all_oleds():
        mux_disable_all()
        print("Scanning mux channels...")
        scan_channels_print()
        for ch in OLED_CHANNELS:
            init_oled_on_channel(ch)
        mux_disable_all()

    def _oled_draw(ch, draw_fn):
        """Robust draw: select ch, draw, show; retry once with re-init if needed."""
        d = OLED_BY_CH.get(ch)
        if not d:
            return
        for _ in range(2):
            try:
                mux_select(ch)
                draw_fn(d)
                time.sleep_us(80)
                d.show()
                mux_disable_all()
                return
            except OSError:
                time.sleep_ms(2)
                init_oled_on_channel(ch)
                d = OLED_BY_CH.get(ch)

    def oled_text(ch, l1="", l2="", l3="", l4=""):
        def _draw(d):
            d.fill(0)
            if l1: d.text(l1, 0, 0)
            if l2: d.text(l2, 0, 16)
            if l3: d.text(l3, 0, 32)
            if l4: d.text(l4, 0, 48)
        _oled_draw(ch, _draw)

    def oled_show_countdowns(current_green_lane, green_end_ms, now_ms, ambulance=None):
```

```
    if ambulance is not None:
        for lane in range(1, 5):
            ch = OLED_CHANNELS[lane-1]
            oled_text(ch, "Ambulance!",
                      f"Lane {ambulance} priority",
                      "Hold 60s", "")
        return
    rem_green = max(0, (green_end_ms - now_ms) // 1000)
    for lane in range(1, 5):
        ch = OLED_CHANNELS[lane-1]
        if lane == current_green_lane:
            oled_text(ch, f"Lane {lane}: GREEN", f"T: {rem_green:>3}s", "", "")
        else:
            ahead = (lane - current_green_lane) % 4
            if ahead == 0: ahead = 4
            red_secs = rem_green + (ahead - 1) * 60
            oled_text(ch, f"Lane {lane}: RED", f"T: {int(red_secs):>3}s", "", "")

# ---------- LEDs + IR ----------
LANE_GREEN_PINS = [2, 3, 4, 5]      # L1..L4
LANE_RED_PINS   = [10, 11, 12, 13]  # L1..L4
IR_PINS         = [6, 7, 8, 9]      # L1..L4
IR_ACTIVE_HIGH  = True

LANE_GREEN = [Pin(p, Pin.OUT, value=0) for p in LANE_GREEN_PINS]
LANE_RED   = [Pin(p, Pin.OUT, value=0) for p in LANE_RED_PINS]
IR_IN      = [Pin(p, Pin.IN) for p in IR_PINS]

def ir_active(i):
    v = IR_IN[i].value()
    return (v == 1) if IR_ACTIVE_HIGH else (v == 0)

def all_red():
    for r in LANE_RED:   r.value(1)
    for g in LANE_GREEN: g.value(0)

def set_lane_green(lane_1b):
    idx = lane_1b - 1
    for i in range(4):
        LANE_GREEN[i].value(1 if i == idx else 0)
        LANE_RED[i].value(0 if i == idx else 1)

# ---------- Wi-Fi + Firebase ----------
try:
    import urequests as requests
except ImportError:
    import requests
```

```
def wifi_connect():
    sta = network.WLAN(network.STA_IF)
    if not sta.active(): sta.active(True)
    if not sta.isconnected():
        print("Wi-Fi: connecting...")
        sta.connect(WIFI_SSID, WIFI_PASS)
        t0 = time.time()
        while not sta.isconnected() and (time.time() - t0) < 25:
            time.sleep(0.25)
    print("Wi-Fi:", "connected" if sta.isconnected() else "failed")
    return sta.isconnected()

_id_token = None
def fb_login():
    global _id_token
    url = "https://identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:signInWithPassword?key=" + API_KEY
    payload = {"email": USER_EMAIL, "password": USER_PASS, "returnSecureToken": True}
    try:
        r = requests.post(url, data=json.dumps(payload),
                          headers={"Content-Type": "application/json"}, timeout=8)
        if r.status_code == 200:
            _id_token = r.json().get("idToken", None)
            print("Firebase: auth OK")
        else:
            print("Firebase auth failed:", r.status_code, r.text)
            _id_token = None
        r.close()
    except Exception as e:
        print("Firebase auth error:", e)
        _id_token = None

def fb_url(path_json):
    url = DB_URL.rstrip("/") + path_json
    if _id_token:
        url += ("&" if "?" in url else "?") + "auth=" + _id_token
    return url

def fb_get_bool(path_json):
    try:
        r = requests.get(fb_url(path_json), timeout=6)
        if r.status_code != 200:
            r.close(); return False
        try:
            val = r.json()
        except Exception:
            t = r.text.strip(); r.close()
            if t.startswith("") and t.endswith(""):
                val = t.strip("")
```

```
            else:
                return False
        r.close()
        if val is None: return False
        if isinstance(val, (int, float)): return int(val) == 1
        s = str(val).strip().lower()
        return s in ("1", "true", "on", "yes")
    except Exception:
        return False

def fb_get_lane_number():
    try:
        r = requests.get(fb_url(LANE_PATH), timeout=6)
        if r.status_code != 200:
            r.close(); return None
        try:
            val = r.json()
        except Exception:
            t = r.text.strip(); r.close()
            if t.startswith("") and t.endswith(""):
                val = t.strip("")
            else:
                return None
        r.close()
        try:
            v = int(val)
            return v if 1 <= v <= 4 else None
        except Exception:
            return None
    except Exception:
        return None

def fb_log(event: dict):
    ev = {"ts_ms": time.ticks_ms()}
    ev.update(event)
    try:
        requests.post(fb_url(LOG_PATH),
                      data=json.dumps(ev),
                      headers={"Content-Type": "application/json"},
                      timeout=6).close()
    except Exception:
        pass

# ---------- Scheduler/state ----------
def ms(): return time.ticks_ms()

GREEN_BASE_S      = 15
GREEN_EXTENSION_S  = 10
```

```
AMBULANCE_GREEN_S  = 15
LANE_POLL_INTERVAL_MS = 700
OLED_REFRESH_MS      = 1000
IR_CHECK_MS          = 100

current_lane   = 1
green_active   = False
green_end_ms   = 0
green_extended = False

last_amb = False
ambulance_active = False
ambulance_lane   = None
ambulance_end_ms = 0

next_oled_ms = 0
next_ir_ms   = 0
next_poll_ms = 0

# ---------- Actions ----------
def lane_start(lane, now, reason="clockwise"):
    global current_lane, green_active, green_end_ms, green_extended
    current_lane = lane
    set_lane_green(lane)
    green_active = True
    green_extended = False
    green_end_ms = time.ticks_add(now, GREEN_BASE_S * 1000)
    fb_log({"type": "green_start", "lane": lane, "reason": reason})

def lane_stop():
    global green_active
    green_active = False
    all_red()

def handle_ir_extend(now):
    global green_extended, green_end_ms
    if green_active and not green_extended and ir_active(current_lane - 1):
        green_end_ms = time.ticks_add(green_end_ms, GREEN_EXTENSION_S * 1000)
        green_extended = True
        fb_log({"type": "green_extended", "lane": current_lane, "extra_s": GREEN_EXTENSION_S})

def ambulance_start(lane, now):
    global ambulance_active, ambulance_lane, ambulance_end_ms
    ambulance_active = True
    ambulance_lane = lane
    lane_stop()
    set_lane_green(lane)
    ambulance_end_ms = time.ticks_add(now, AMBULANCE_GREEN_S * 1000)
```

```
    fb_log({"type": "ambulance_start", "lane": lane})

def ambulance_stop():
    global ambulance_active, ambulance_lane
    ambulance_active = False
    fb_log({"type": "ambulance_end", "lane": ambulance_lane})
    next_lane = (ambulance_lane % 4) + 1
    ambulance_lane = None
    lane_start(next_lane, ms(), reason="resume_after_ambulance")

def init_system():
    all_red()
    init_all_oleds()
    for i, ch in enumerate(OLED_CHANNELS, start=1):
        oled_text(ch, f"Lane {i}", "Ready", "", "")
    time.sleep_ms(300)

# ---------- Main ----------
def main():
    global next_oled_ms, next_ir_ms, next_poll_ms, last_amb
    if wifi_connect(): fb_login()
    init_system()

    now = ms()
    lane_start(1, now, reason="startup")
    next_oled_ms = next_ir_ms = next_poll_ms = now

    try:
        while True:
            now = ms()

            # Poll ambulance flag
            if time.ticks_diff(now, next_poll_ms) >= 0:
                amb = fb_get_bool(AMBULANCE_PATH)
                if (not last_amb) and amb and (not ambulance_active):
                    lane_from_esp = fb_get_lane_number() or 1
                    ambulance_start(lane_from_esp, now)
                last_amb = amb
                next_poll_ms = time.ticks_add(now, LANE_POLL_INTERVAL_MS)

            # If ambulance active: update banner + timing
            if ambulance_active:
                if time.ticks_diff(now, ambulance_end_ms) >= 0:
                    ambulance_stop()
                else:
                    if time.ticks_diff(now, next_oled_ms) >= 0:
                        rem = max(0, (ambulance_end_ms - now)//1000)
                        for lane in range(1,5):
```

```
                    ch = OLED_CHANNELS[lane-1]
                    oled_text(ch, "Ambulance!",
                              f"Lane {ambulance_lane} priority",
                              f"T: {int(rem):>3}s", "")
                next_oled_ms = time.ticks_add(now, OLED_REFRESH_MS)
            time.sleep_ms(5)
            continue

        # Normal cycle
        if green_active and time.ticks_diff(now, green_end_ms) >= 0:
            lane_stop()
            lane_start((current_lane % 4) + 1, now, reason="clockwise")

        if green_active and time.ticks_diff(now, next_ir_ms) >= 0:
            handle_ir_extend(now)
            next_ir_ms = time.ticks_add(now, IR_CHECK_MS)

        if time.ticks_diff(now, next_oled_ms) >= 0:
            oled_show_countdowns(current_lane, green_end_ms, now)
            next_oled_ms = time.ticks_add(now, OLED_REFRESH_MS)

        time.sleep_ms(5)
    except KeyboardInterrupt:
        pass
    finally:
        all_red()
        mux_disable_all()

# Run
main()
```